

The AI Brain Workshop Guide

Build a Claude Cowork that knows your business, your judgment, and your voice.
*A self-paced guide. Read at your own pace and do each step as you go. Stuck on anything?
Bring it to the live Q&A.*

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How this workshop works

This is a **build-along**. You're not just reading. By the end, you'll have a working AI Brain you built for yourself.

- **The reading** teaches you *what* you're building and *why* each piece matters.
- **The illustrated steps** show you *exactly where to click* for the hands-on parts.
- **You can't break anything**. Go step-by-step, pause whenever, re-run any step. There are no wrong answers.

Time: reading through is ~30–40 minutes. The full build, doing each step as you go, is **~2–3 hours**. That's normal. Most of that time is *you* answering questions about your own business (which is the whole point).

Try this right now (10 seconds)

Before you build anything, feel the difference one instruction makes. Open Claude and type any request you'd normally make — then add nine words to the end:

"We are in Plan Mode. Ask me questions first."

Instead of guessing, Claude will ask you the right questions before it starts. That's the entire idea of this workshop in miniature: *the more Claude knows before it answers, the better the answer*. Today you'll make that automatic.

Your progress checklist

Check these off as you go. This is your map. You'll know exactly where to pick back up.

- ☐ **Pre-flight done** — Claude Pro/Max, desktop app installed, 3–5 writing samples handy
- ☐ **Section 3 — Global Instructions set** (Layer 1)
- ☐ My AI Brain folder created (Setup Guide 1)
- ☐ Plugin installed & enabled (Setup Guide 2)
- ☐ Folder connected & /business-brief run — first file landed (Setup Guide 3)
- ☐ **/knowledge-domains, /judgment-patterns, /voice-style run** (Setup Guide 4)
- ☐ **/blueprint-synthesis run** — CLAUDE.md written, AI Brain is live (Setup Guide 4)
- ☐ **Tested** — ran the Section 5 prompts; answers sound like you
- ☐ **First custom skill built** with /skill-creator (Section 6)

Pre-Flight

Do these four things before you start so you can build without getting blocked partway through.

1. Get a Claude Pro account. (\$20/month) The free tier won't run what we're building.

<https://claude.com/pricing>

2. Download the Claude desktop app. Get it at <https://claude.com/download> and sign in. We build everything in **Cowork** inside the desktop app. The browser version won't work for this.

3. **Set aside 2–3 hours.** A thorough first pass could take 2–3 hours. You don't have to do it all at once. Your files save as you go, so you can split them across two or more sittings.
4. **Organize your materials in advance:** It goes faster if you bring existing materials (writing samples, the URL for your About page, sales page, bio, or resume) to draw on for the skills.
5. **Gather 3–5 good writing samples.** Emails, posts, messages. Anything that sounds like you. You'll use these when we capture your voice. Do not use AI-generated content.
6. **Download the AI Brain Plugin:** Get it at: <https://aiinnercircle.com/ai-brain/access> and save it to your Downloads. Don't double-click it. You'll install it in Setup Guide 2.

What You're Building

By the end, you'll have three things:

1. **Global Instructions** — Claude knows who you are in every Cowork session
2. **An AI Brain** — a Cowork folder encoded with your expertise, judgment, and voice, that Claude applies automatically
3. **Your first global skill** — a reusable tool you built yourself that works across every Cowork session

One important note before we start: we're building all of this in **Cowork**, not in a Claude Project. Projects are great for scoped client work, but they make you copy, paste, and re-upload files every time something changes. Cowork skips all of that and skills write files straight into a folder on your computer. Claude reads them automatically, so you get less friction, more building.

Section 1 — The Problem

Every time you open a new chat with Claude, you start over.

You type your question. Claude answers. The response is ok, but it doesn't know you. It doesn't know your business, your clients, your voice, or how you think. It's answering a question for you the same way it does for everyone else.

So you add context. You explain your situation. You describe your audience. You clarify what you mean. You say "I'm a [role] and my clients are [type of person]."

Sound familiar?

You're just paying a tax most people don't know exists: the “**starting-from-zero tax.**”

What It Costs You

Every time you re-explain yourself, you're doing two things:

1. **Wasting time.** The first 3–5 exchanges of most AI conversations are just orientation. You're just getting Claude up to speed on who you are. Multiply that across 10 conversations a day, and you're spending a real chunk of your time just establishing context.
2. **Getting generic output.** When Claude doesn't know you, it defaults to average answers and language that could apply to anyone. The more it knows about you, the more specific — and more useful — its output becomes.

The Compounding Effect

Here's what changes when Claude knows you. You ask: *"How should I price this new offer?"* Without context, Claude gives you a framework. Useful, but generic.

With context — your market, your positioning, your judgment patterns, your past decisions — Claude gives you a recommendation that sounds like it came from a business partner who knows you.

That's personalization. And it compounds the more you use it. The founders getting the most out of AI aren't the ones who know the best prompts. They're the ones who've taken the time to encode who they are into the tool. That's what this workshop is about.

Section 2 — The Two Layers of Personalization

Before we build anything, you need a mental model for how personalization works in Claude. There are two layers. We build both today.

Layer	Name	What it does	Where it works
1	Global Instructions	Tells Claude who you are and how to work with you	Every Cowork session
2	AI Brain (a Cowork folder + CLAUDE.md)	Encodes your expertise, judgment, and voice	Inside your AI Brain folder

Layer 1 — Global Instructions

This is the foundation. Your Cowork Global Instructions live in your Claude settings and load automatically in every Cowork session. You set them once, and they run in the background permanently. This is where you put the things that are always true: who you are, how you want Claude to communicate, the rules that apply 80% of the time.

We build this in Section 3.

Layer 2 — Your AI Brain

This goes deeper. Your AI Brain is a **folder on your computer** that Claude treats as a dedicated workspace. It holds a handful of knowledge files plus one special file called CLAUDE.md:

- **Your business** — what the company is, what you sell, what you stand for (business-brief.md)
- **Your expertise** — what you know, how you think about your domain (knowledge-domains.md)
- **Your judgment** — how you make decisions, what you avoid, your real filters (judgment-patterns.md)
- **Your voice** — how you communicate, your brand personality, what you never say (voice-style.md)

The difference between Layer 1 and Layer 2 is the difference between Claude knowing you and Claude knowing who you are, what you are good at doing, how you *think*, and how you make decisions.

We build this in Sections 4 and 5.

What CLAUDE.md Actually Is

CLAUDE.md is the file that makes the folder an AI Brain instead of just a folder. In Cowork, whenever you open a folder that has a CLAUDE.md in it, Claude reads that file **automatically** before you type anything. You won't write it by hand; the last skill you run today writes it for you.

Why the Order Matters

You could skip straight to building your AI Brain. The problem is that Layer 2 only works inside that one desktop folder. The moment you start a different Cowork task, the context of that folder doesn't follow. Layer 1 does. It's there in every Cowork session. Build the foundation first. Then build the room.

Section 3 — Build Your General Instructions

~10 minutes · This is your first build step

This is the most underused feature in Claude. It takes a few minutes to set up. And once it's done, every Cowork session starts with Claude already knowing who you are.

Note: this is your Cowork Global instructions (Settings → Cowork → Global instructions), not the General tab in Claude.ai settings.

Where to Find It

In the Claude desktop app:

1. Click your **name** in the lower-left panel
2. Go to **Settings** → **Cowork**
3. Find **Global instructions** and click **Edit**
4. You'll see a text box. That's it.

Whatever you write there loads automatically into every Cowork session. Claude never tells you it's reading it; it just uses it.

What to Put In It

You write four categories, in this order:

1. **Who you are.** Your role, what you do, who you serve. One or two sentences. Be specific — not "I'm an entrepreneur" but what kind, doing what.
2. **How you want Claude to communicate.** Length, tone, format preferences. Short answers or detailed ones? Should Claude ask questions before diving in? Do you hate bullet points? Say so here.
3. **Your process preferences.** How you like to work. Want a plan before execution? Want pushback before Claude just does the thing? Any workflow that applies to most of your work.
4. **Domain-specific rules (optional).** One or two areas where Claude needs a specific approach every time. Keep it to the 20% of rules that apply 80% of the time. Save the rest for Layer 2.

Real Example: Rev's Global Instructions

Here's what mine actually say:

About Me:

I am a GTM and Revenue Growth Strategist. I create high-converting marketing campaigns and copy.

Ask any questions before doing complex tasks.

For complex multi-step processes, tell me how you plan to do it and create a high-level outline.

Keep answers short and to the point.

Avoid being overly enthusiastic when it is not warranted.

When building Claude skills, systems, and processes: 1) Let's start by talking strategy first before building. 2) Then let's architect the skill, system, or process. 3) Work backward from the goal. 4) Ask key strategy questions.

That's six sentences and a four-step list. Less than 100 words.

Your Template

Use this as a starting point. Fill in what applies. Remove what doesn't.

About Me:

[Your role in one sentence. What you do and who you serve.]

Communication:

[How you want Claude to respond. Length, tone, format. What to avoid.]

Before starting complex tasks:

[Do you want Claude to ask questions first? Show a plan? Get approval before acting?]

[Optional — domain-specific rules:]

[Any workflow or approach Claude should follow every time for your most common work.]

Example (filled in for a founder-led brand owner):

About Me:

I run a premium coaching business for high-ticket B2B service providers. I sell transformation, not hours.

Communication:

Keep answers short and direct. No bullet-point walls. Ask one clarifying question at a time, not five at once. Never start a response with a compliment.

Before starting complex tasks:

Ask me questions about what you need to know before building anything. Show your plan and wait for approval before executing.

When writing copy or content:

Lead with the problem, not the intro. Write like you're talking to a peer, not a prospect. No corporate language.

Common Mistakes

Too long. Instructions that run 500 words try to cover everything and end up ignored. Stick to the rules that apply to 80% of your work.

Too vague. "Be helpful and professional" tells Claude nothing new. Be specific: "Give me your candid insight even if I won't like it."

Trying to make it do everything. Global Instructions are defaults, not a full system. Complex workflows belong in your AI Brain folder.

Never updating it. Your instructions should evolve as you figure out what you actually need.

Quick Power-User Move

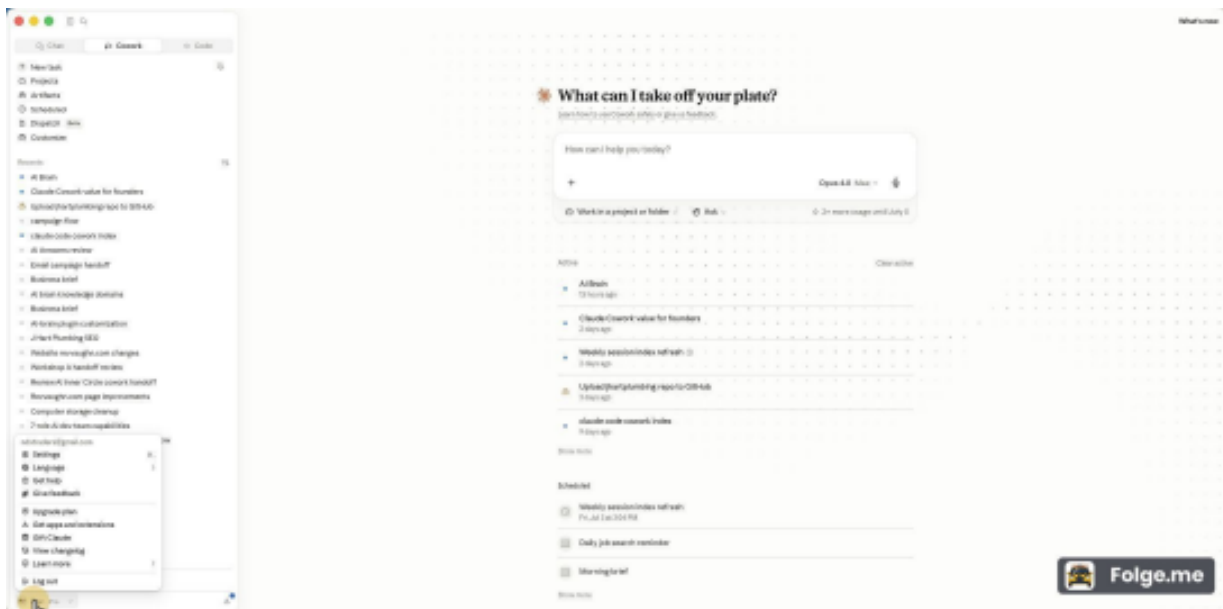
One line that makes any prompt work better: *"[Your request here]. Ask me questions first."* Instead of Claude guessing what you want and diving in, it asks you the right questions before it starts. Better output, half the time. Add it to the end of any complex request.

Do this now

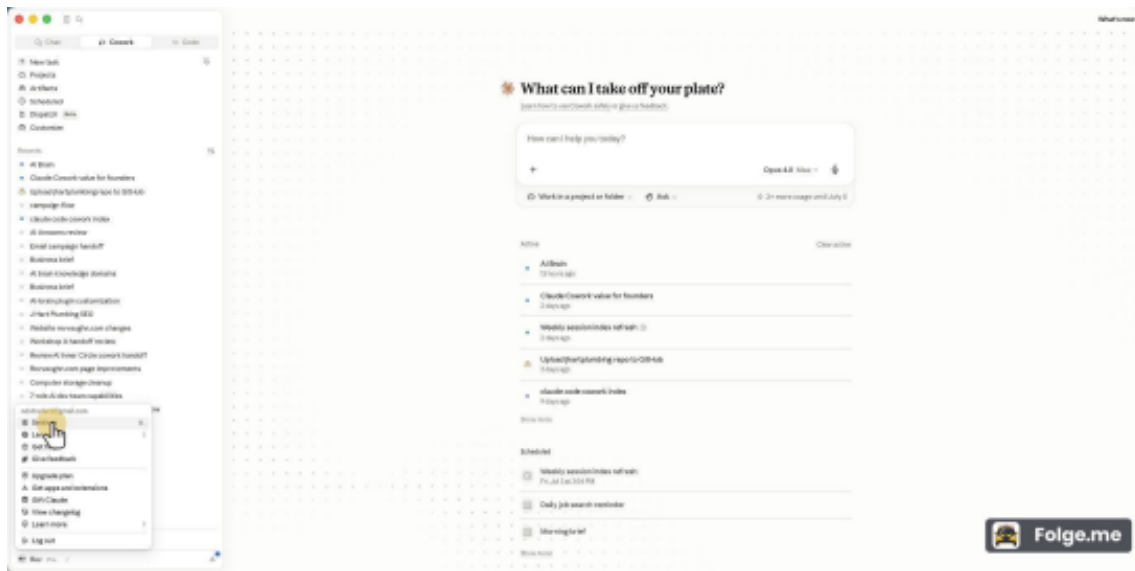
Open **Settings** → **Cowork** → **Global instructions** → **Edit**, write your instructions using the four buckets above (under ~150 words), and save. You won't get a confirmation. Claude just uses it from now on. *Check it off: Global Instructions set.*

Create Your General Instructions

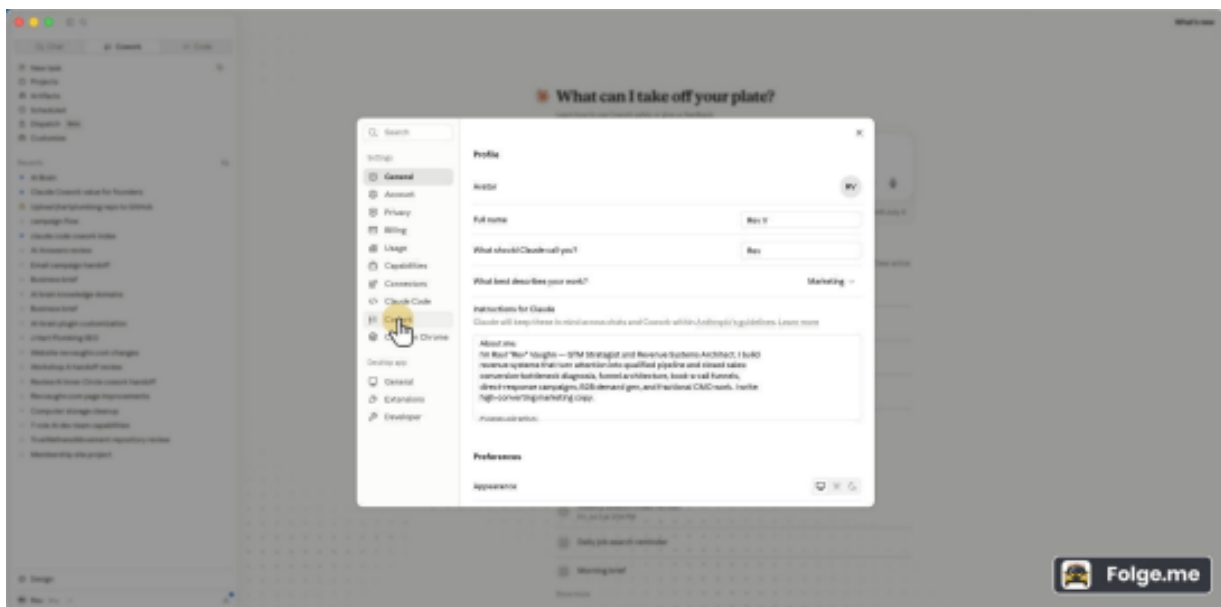
1 Click Your Name



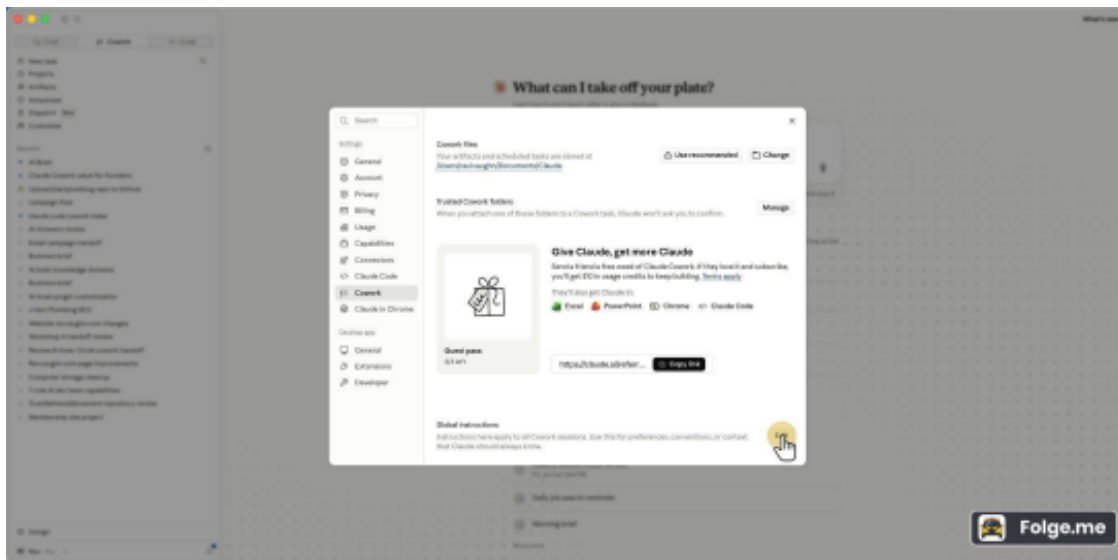
2 Click "Settings"



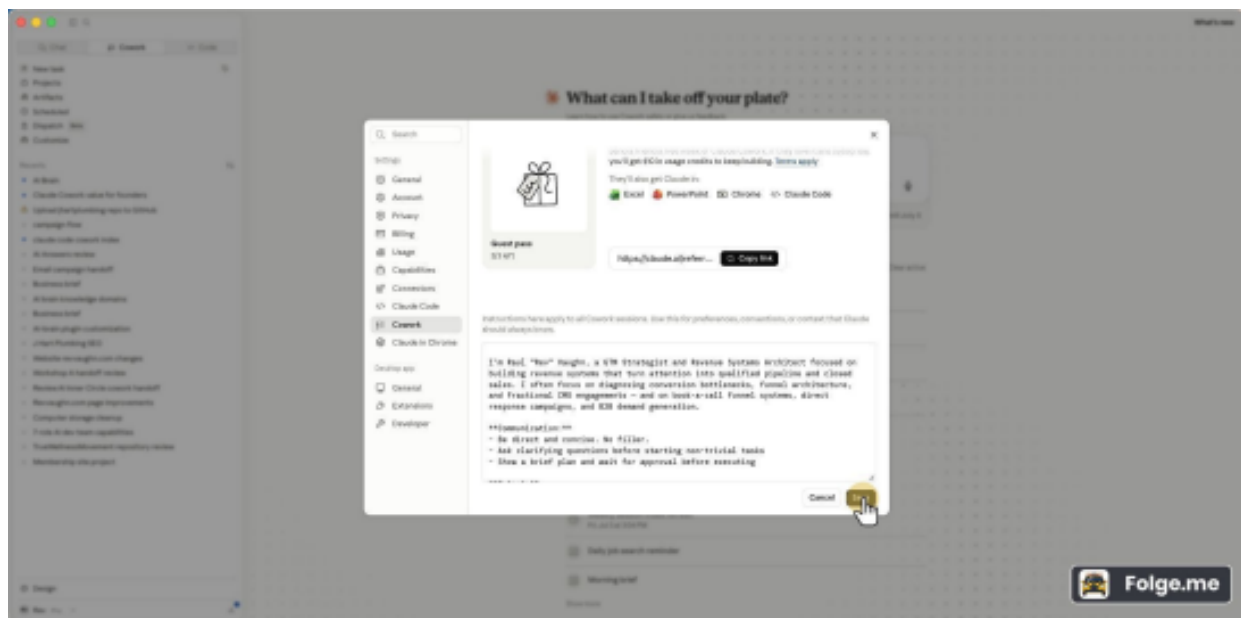
3 Click "Cowork"



4 Scroll down and click "Global instructions"



5 Enter who you are and your work preferences. Click "Save"



Layer 1 is done and saved permanently. It's already working in every session.

Section 4 is the longest stretch (~30–45 min), so if you're short on time, stop here and come back fresh. Your progress is safe. If you are ready to continue, let's move on.

Section 4 — Build Your AI Brain (The Skills)

~30–45 minutes · the heart of the build. This is where Cowork earns its keep. You'll run a short series of skills. Each one hands you a short form — pre-filled with what Claude already knows — then writes a file straight into your AI Brain folder.

The setup and the click-by-click of running the skills are illustrated with screenshots showing where to click. Read the why, then follow the screenshots there. We start by getting into Cowork and installing the plugin (Setup Guides 1 and 2), then we run the skills (Setup Guides 3 and 4).

Download the AI Brain Plugin Here:

<https://aiinnercircle.com/ai-brain/access>

Setup Guide 1 — Open Cowork & Create Your Folder

~2 minutes. By the end, your AI Brain folder is created, ready to connect (Setup Guide 3). "Connecting" a folder just gives Claude permission to read and write files inside that one folder and nowhere else. You can't break anything.

(A "task" is just a chat session where Cowork can read and write files on your computer.)

1. Open the Claude desktop app and sign in. Cowork lives here, not the browser.
2. Switch to Cowork at the top of the window.
3. Create your folder: make a new folder on your Desktop named "My AI Brain." You'll connect it in Setup Guide 3.

Setup Guide 2 — Install & Enable the AI Brain Plugin

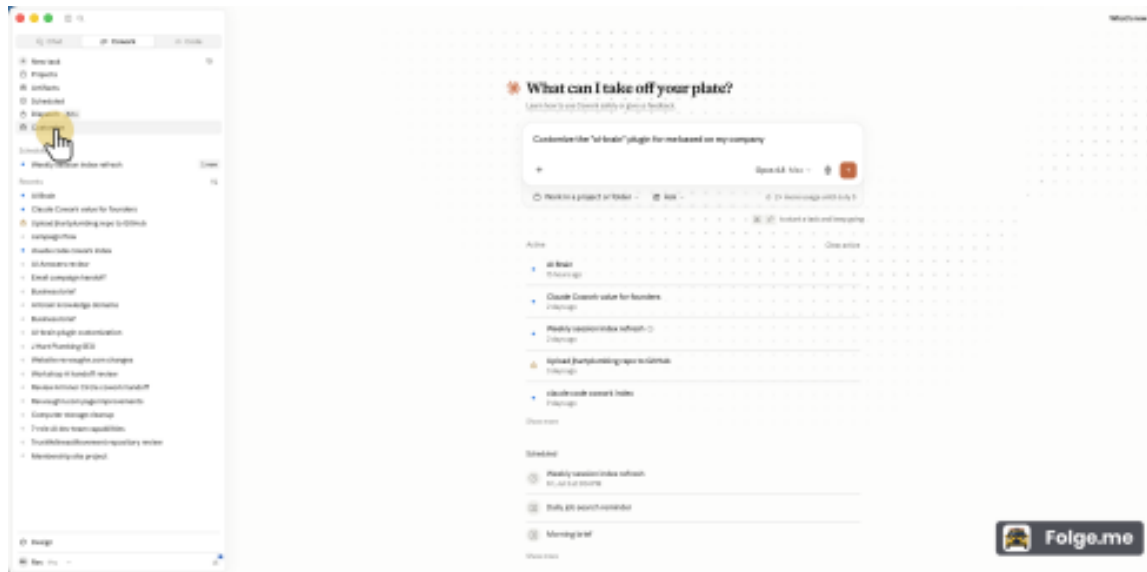
~2 minutes. A plugin adds new / commands to Cowork. You install it once. By the end: typing a "/" command shows your ai-brain skills.

Download ai-brain.plugin. **Don't double-click it.** Then follow these steps:

1. In the Claude Cowork left sidebar, click Customize.
2. Click Browse plugins.
3. Click the Personal tab.
4. Click the +.
5. Click Upload plugin.
6. Click Browse files.
7. Select ai-brain.plugin from Downloads.
8. Click Open.
9. Click Upload.
10. Click the gear icon.
11. Double-click AI Brain.
12. Click Manage and switch the plugin on (if not already on).

The plugin needs no setup of its own. You may need to switch it on. **If you see a Customize button on the plugin "manage" screen, ignore it. Don't click it.**

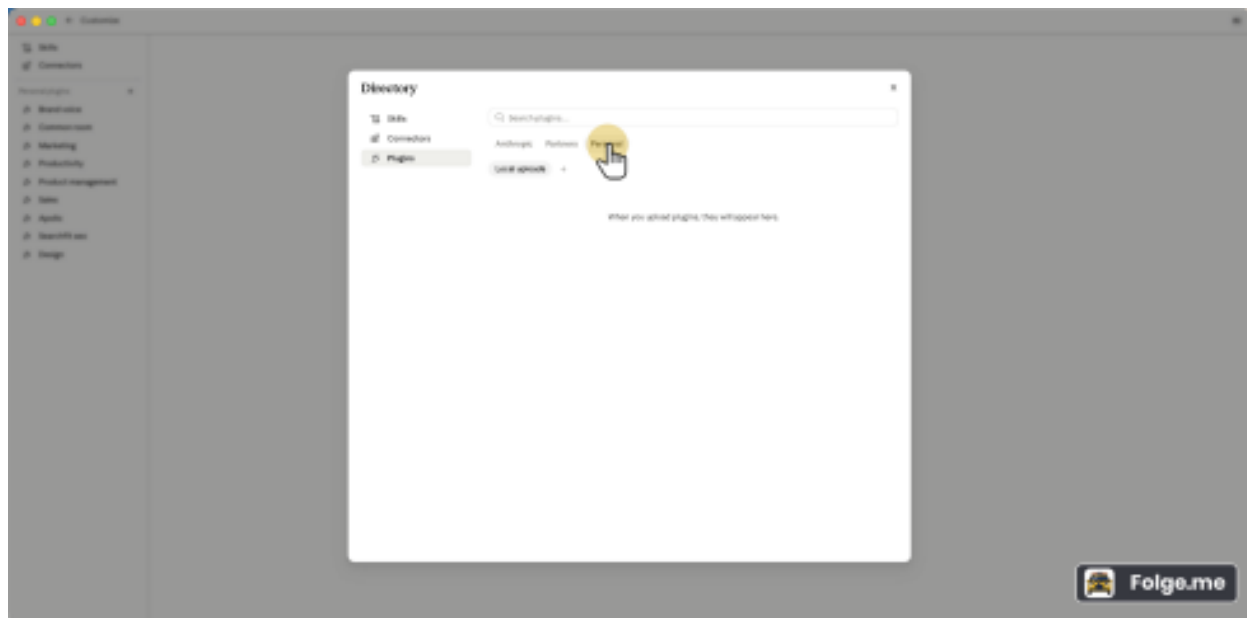
1 Click "Customize"



2 Click "Browse plugins"



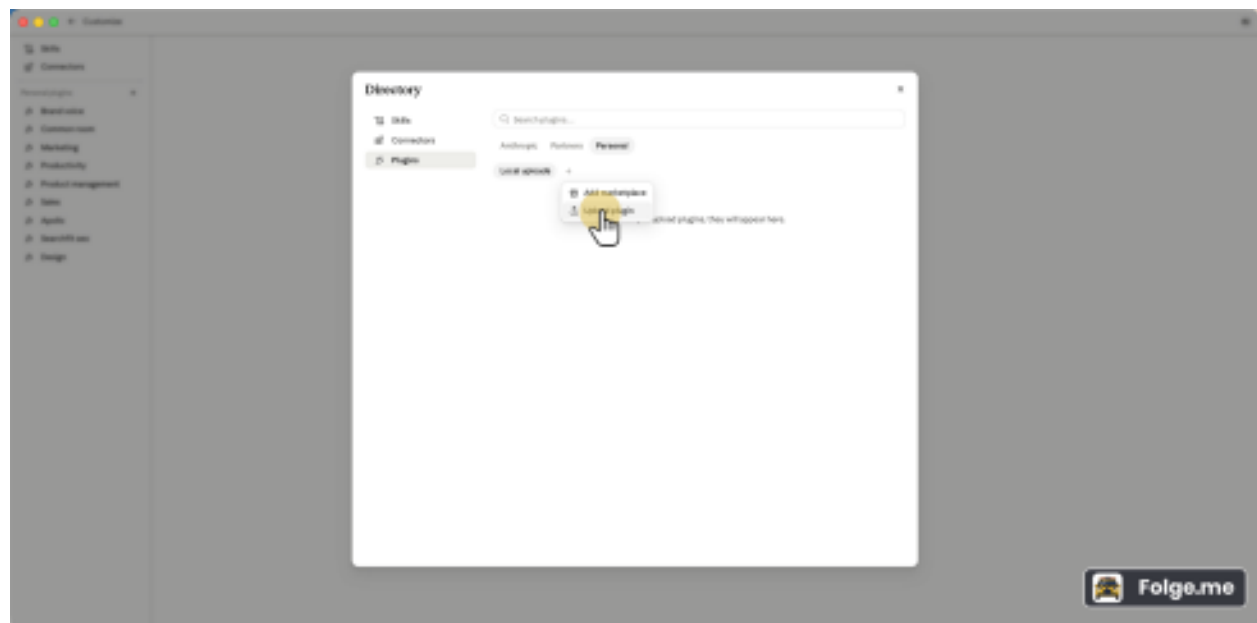
3 Click Personal



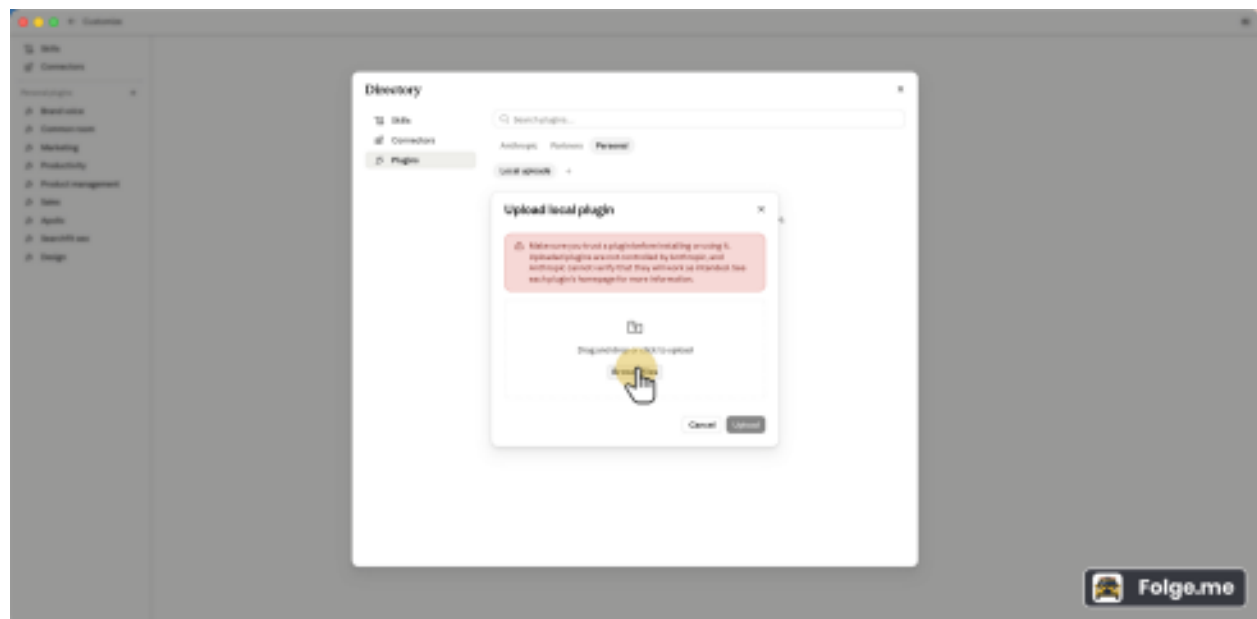
4 Click the "+" sign



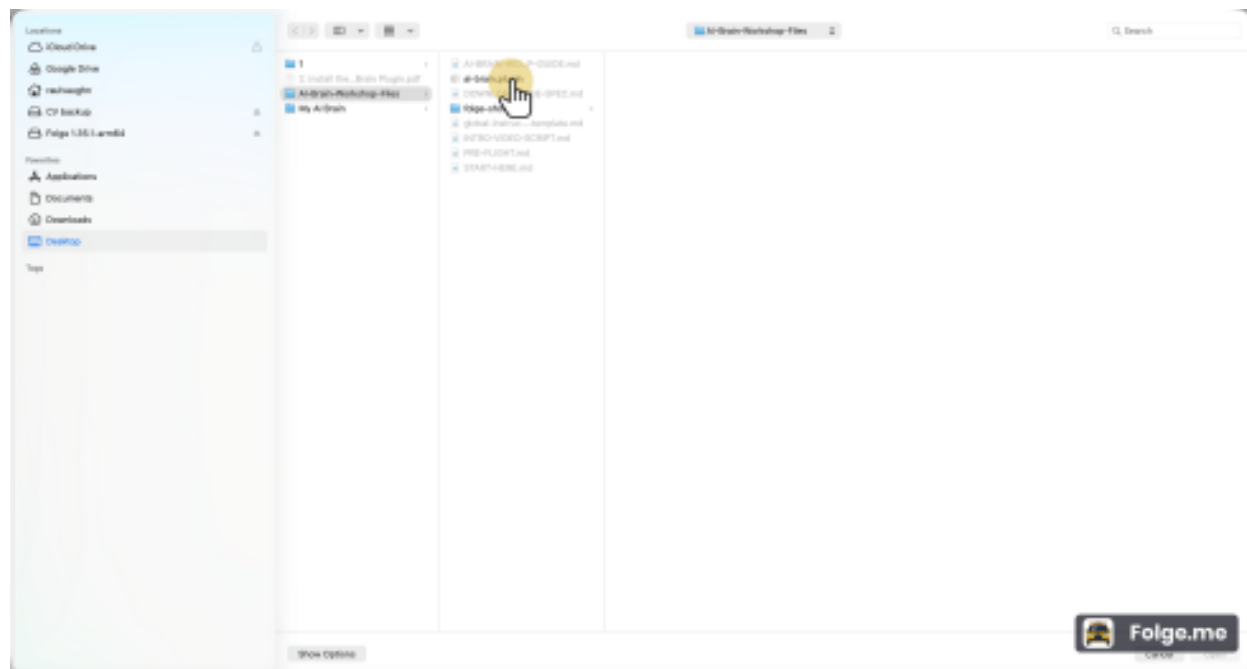
5 Click "upload plugin"



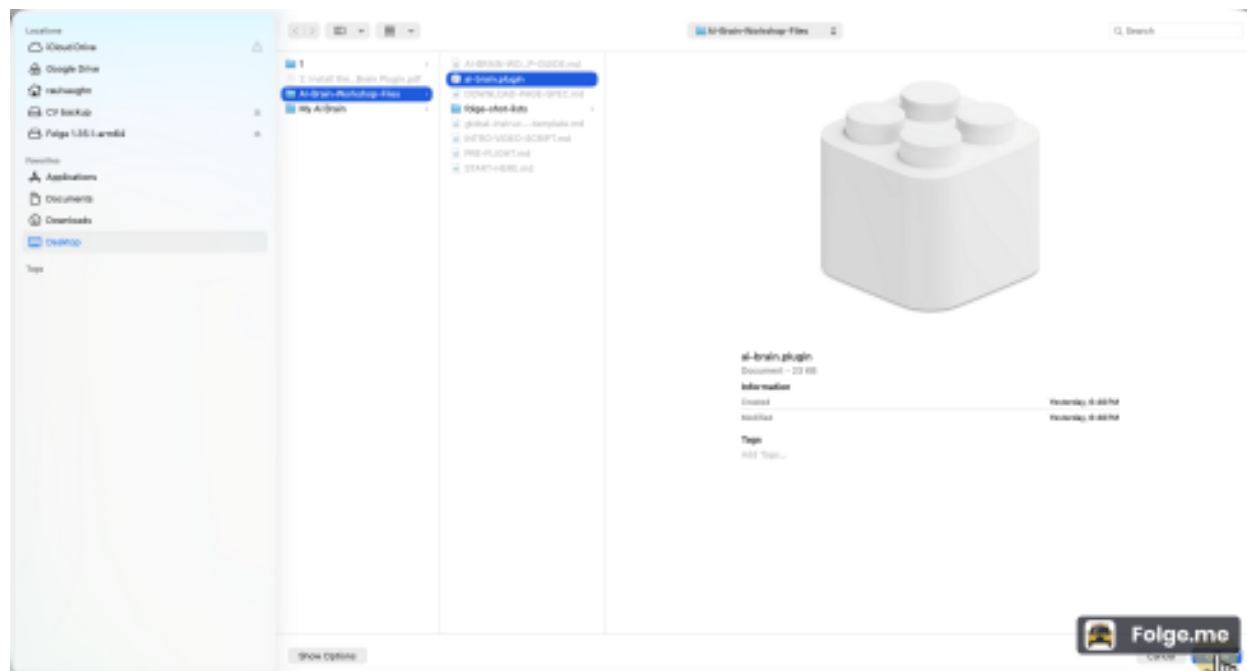
6 Click "Browse files"



7 Click "ai-brain.plugin"



8 Click "Open"



9 Click upload



10 Click the "gear icon" OR



11 Double-click "AI Brain"



12 Click "Manage" and turn the plugin



What Each Skill Captures

You'll run these skills. They all work the **exact same way**: type /, pick the skill from the menu, fill out one short pre-filled form, answer the follow-ups, and it writes a file into your folder. Setup Guide 3 walks the very first one (/business-brief) click by click; Setup Guide 4 covers the rest.

Step	Type this	What it captures	Writes
1	/business-brief	What your business is — offer, audience, what you stand for	business-brief.md
2	/knowledge-domains	What you're the go-to for + what you see that others miss	knowledge-domains.md
3	/judgment-patterns	How you make decisions — real calls → the principle behind them	judgment-patterns.md
4	/voice-style	Your voice, brand, and editorial rules (paste 3-5 writing samples)	voice-style.md
5	/blueprint-synthesis	Reads your files, assembles your AI Brain (run last)	CLAUDE.md

How deep to go fast — first time through, pick Quick on every skill. Each skill offers Quick, Standard, or Deep Dive up front. Resist the urge to go deep on your first pass. Choose Quick every time, get your *whole* brain built end to end (about 20–30 minutes), and only then come back to deepen the one or two files that matter most. A finished rough draft beats a perfect, half-built brain.



Short on time today? The four core skills at Quick depth (business-brief, knowledge-domains, judgment-patterns, voice-style) plus blueprint-synthesis is already a complete, working AI Brain. Deeper passes can wait.

One rule that saves the most trouble: running a skill is **not** opening a file. You type /, pick the skill from the menu, press Enter. If you ever find yourself browsing folders for a SKILL.md, stop — that won't run it. It's installed; you just call it by typing a "/" slash command + the skill name.

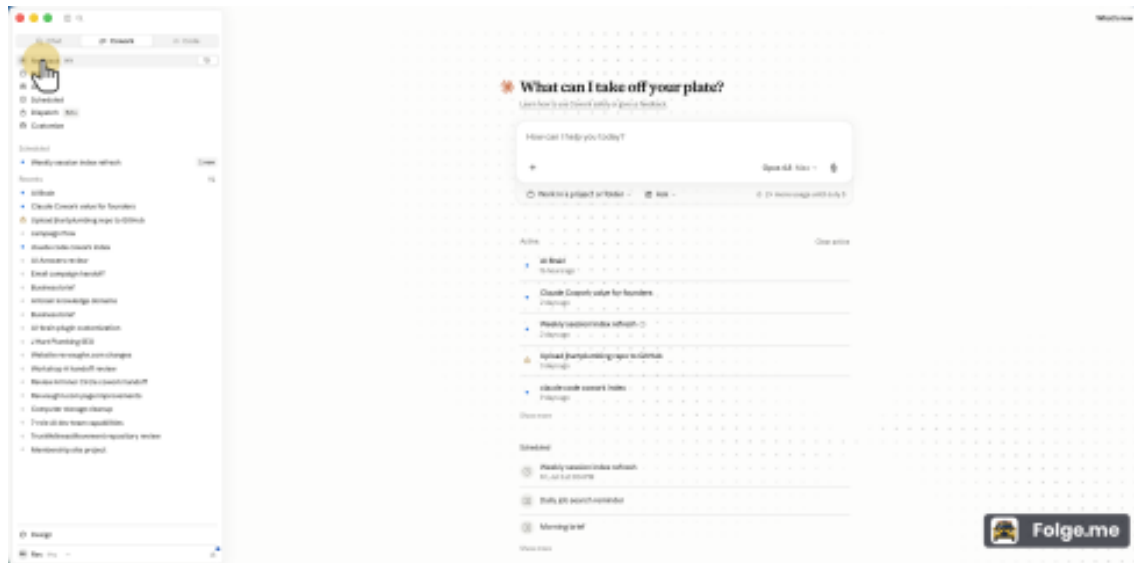
Setup Guide 3 — Connect Your Folder & Run Your First Skill

~5 minutes. By the end: your folder is connected, and your first knowledge file, business-brief.md, is in your folder. And you'll know the exact flow every other skill uses.

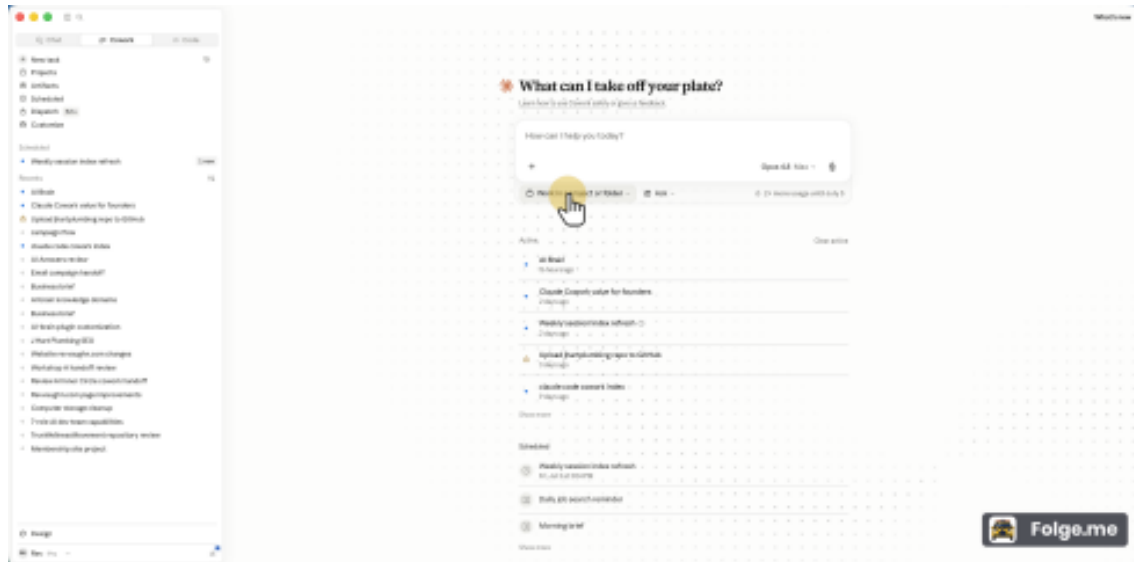
1. Click New task.
2. Click Work in a project or folder.
3. Click Desktop.
4. Click My AI Brain.
5. Click Open. If prompted, Allow access. Connect only this one folder. If more than one is connected, the skills will ask which to use.
6. Type /business-brief and hit Enter. Type only the command and select the skill.
7. Click Start task.
8. Fill in your Business brief details (It's partially pre-filled. Fix what's off, pick a depth).
9. Enter or paste a link to your website(s), About, or sales page.
10. Upload any relevant files about you and your business.
11. Click the files to upload, then click Open.
12. Click Continue.
13. Review and answer any questions.
14. Click Send message.
15. Review your Business Brief core identity.
16. Click the Show in folder dropdown.
17. Open business-brief.md in a text editor.
18. Review and edit your Business Brief.

That flow — command, form, answer + uploads, file, review, edit — is every skill.

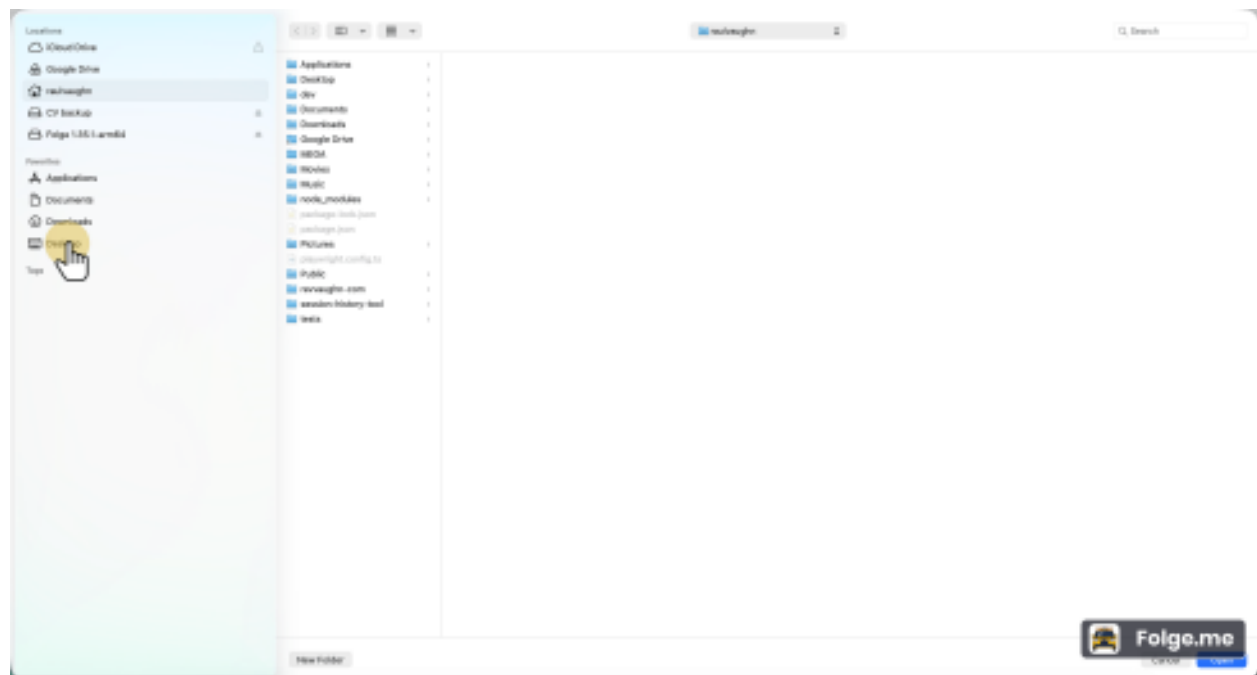
1 Click "New task"



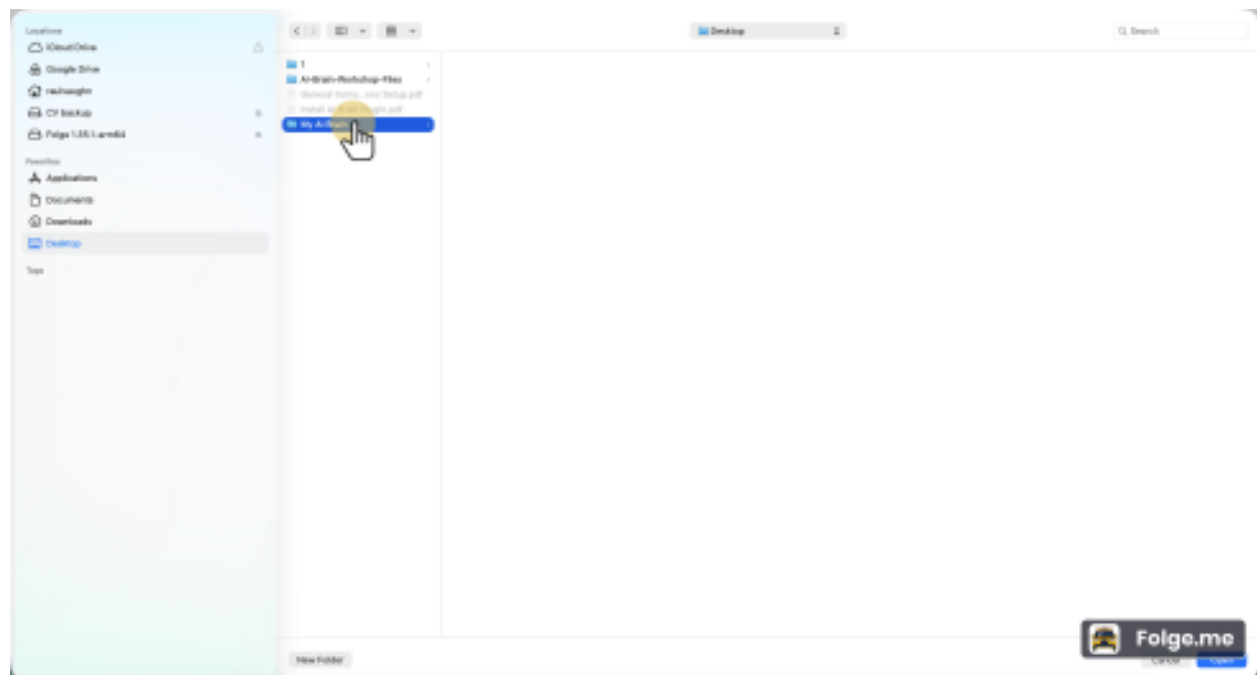
2 Click "Work in a project or folder"



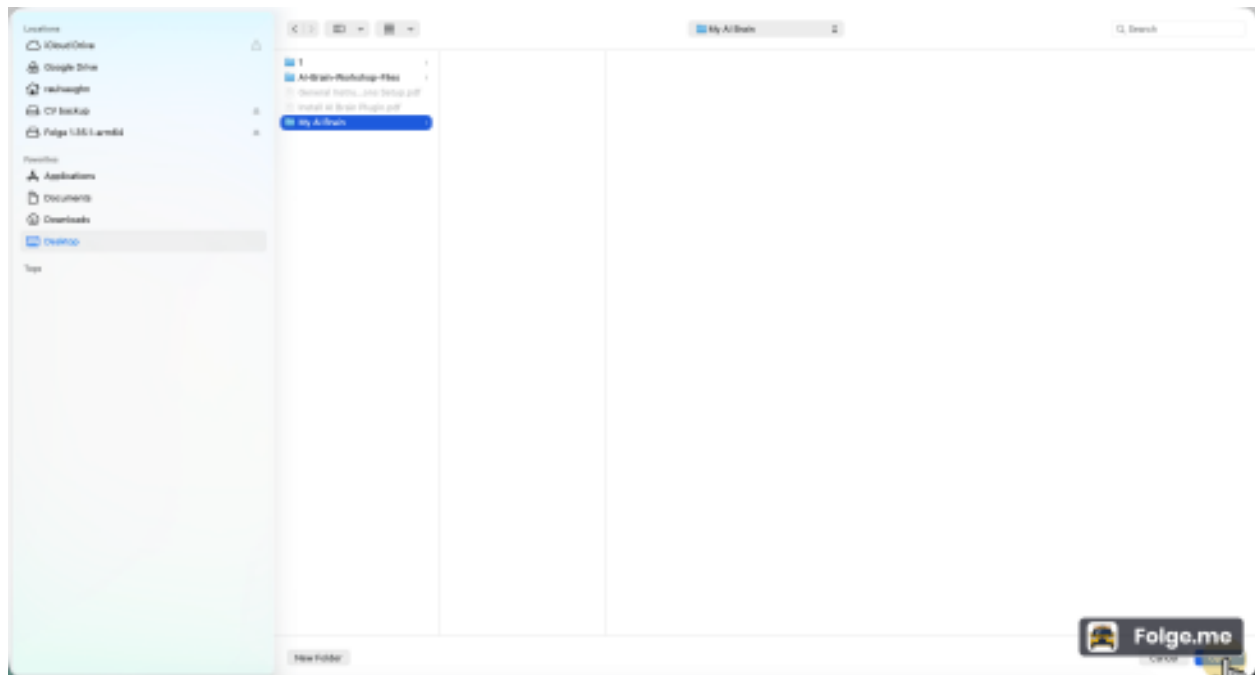
3 Click "Desktop"



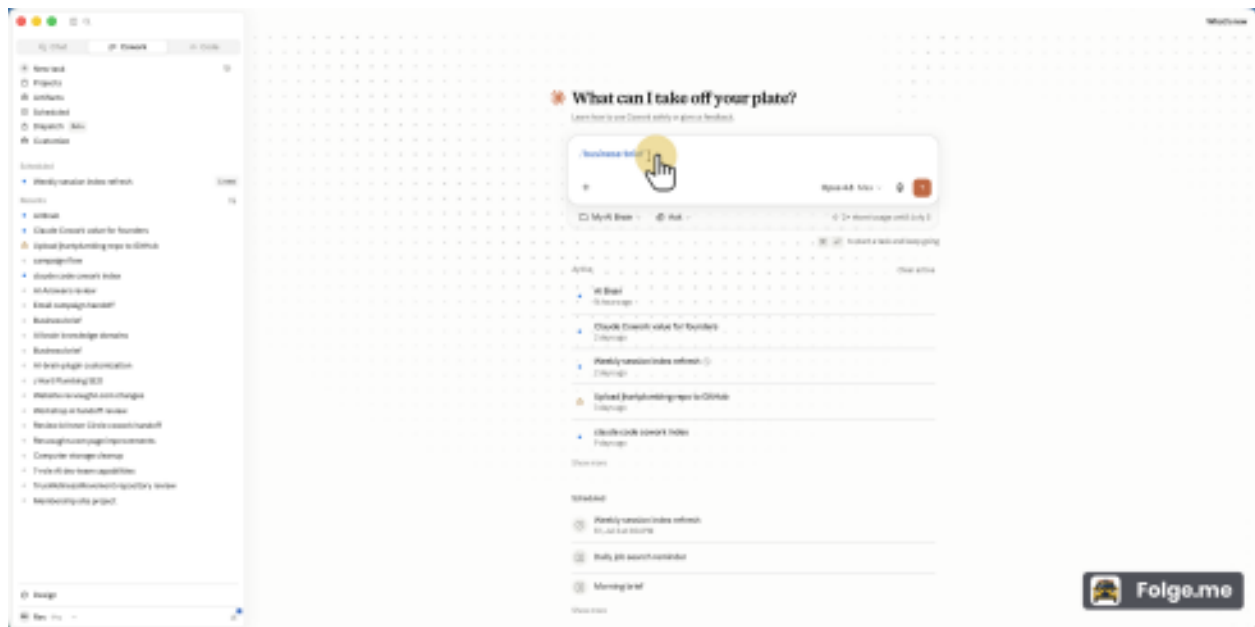
4 Click "My AI Brain"



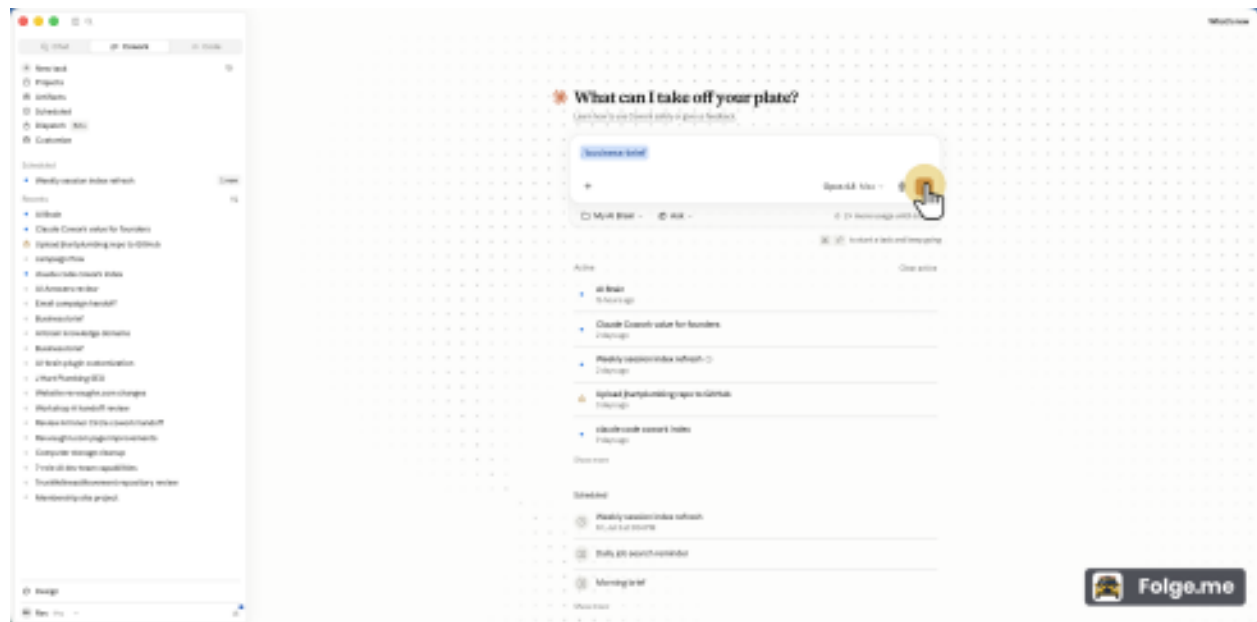
5 Click "Open"



6 Type "/business-brief" and hit enter



7 Click "Start task"



8 Fill in your Business brief details.



9 Enter a link to your website(s)/About/sales page, etc.

Businesscard4U

2-3 principles you want compressed into 1 proposal - value

e.g. clarity over brevity, data over opinion, no vanity metrics

How many should I get?

Quick 30 seconds to get Standard 3 minutes to get Deep 10 minutes to get

Get an About page, sales page, or don't? Explain it (or paste a link, say yes)

Choose file

index my website
www.mymagazine.com

Write a message...

Send

Folge.me

10 Upload any relevant files about you and your business

Businesscard4U

2-3 principles you want compressed into 1 proposal - value

e.g. clarity over brevity, data over opinion, no vanity metrics

How many should I get?

Quick 30 seconds to get Standard 3 minutes to get Deep 10 minutes to get

Get an About page, sales page, or don't? Explain it (or paste a link, say yes)

Choose file

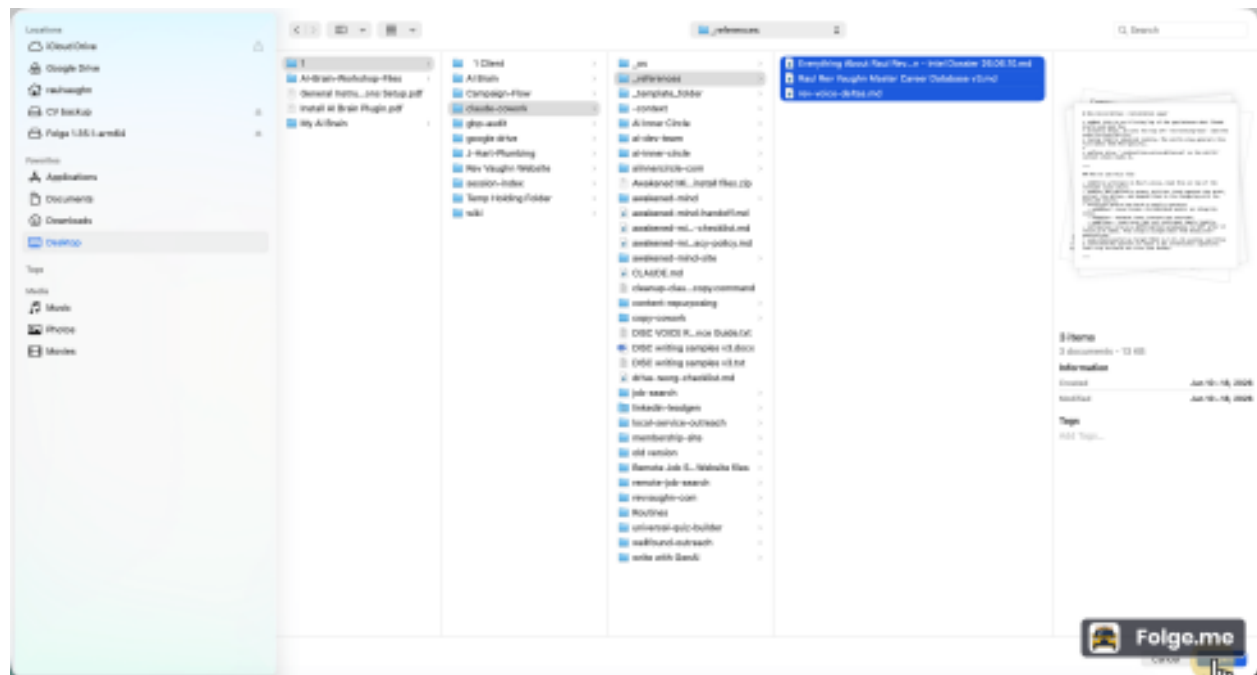
index my website
www.mymagazine.com

Write a message...

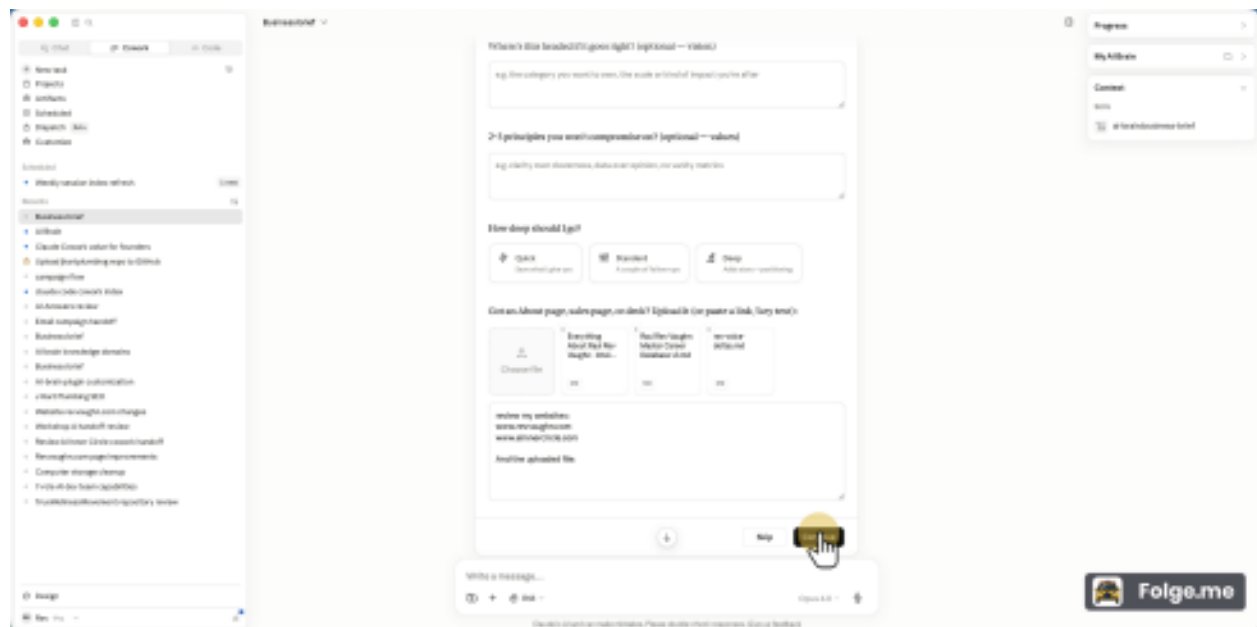
Send

Folge.me

11 Click the files to upload, then click "Open"



12 Click "Continue"



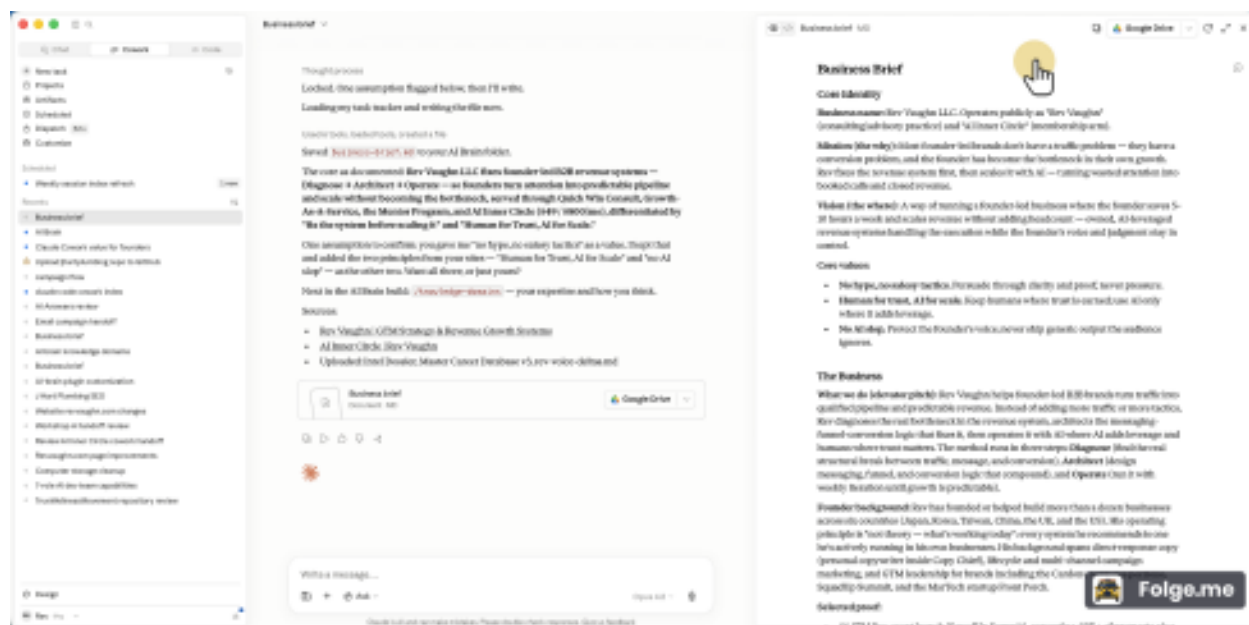
13 Review and answer any questions



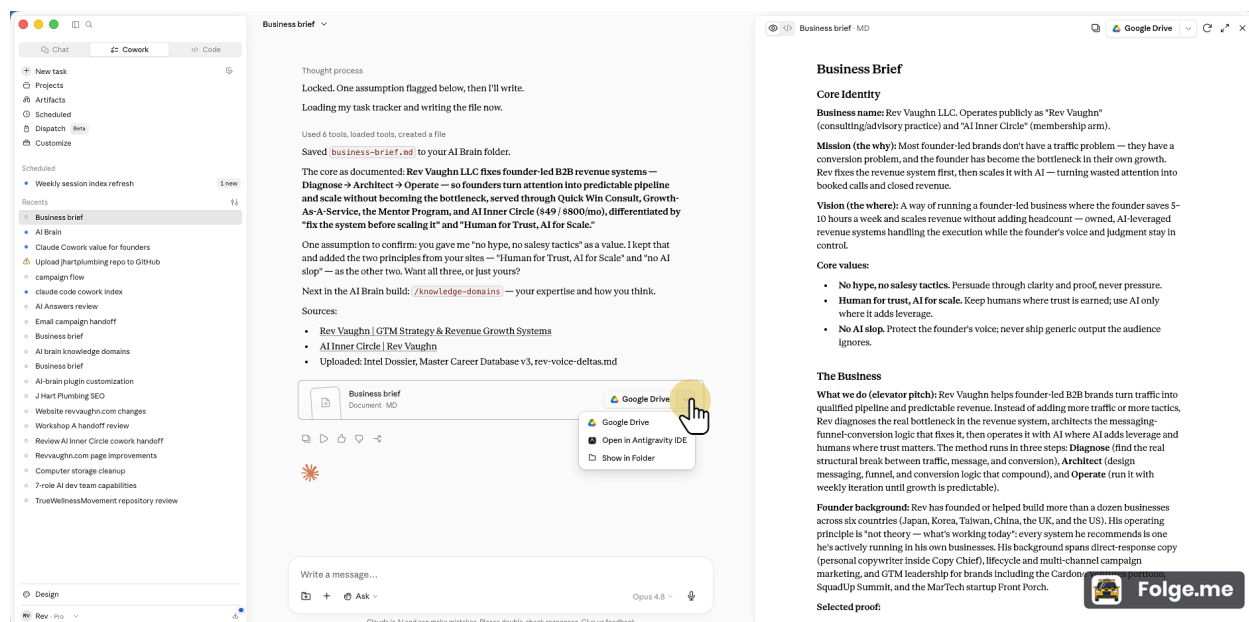
14 Click "Send message"



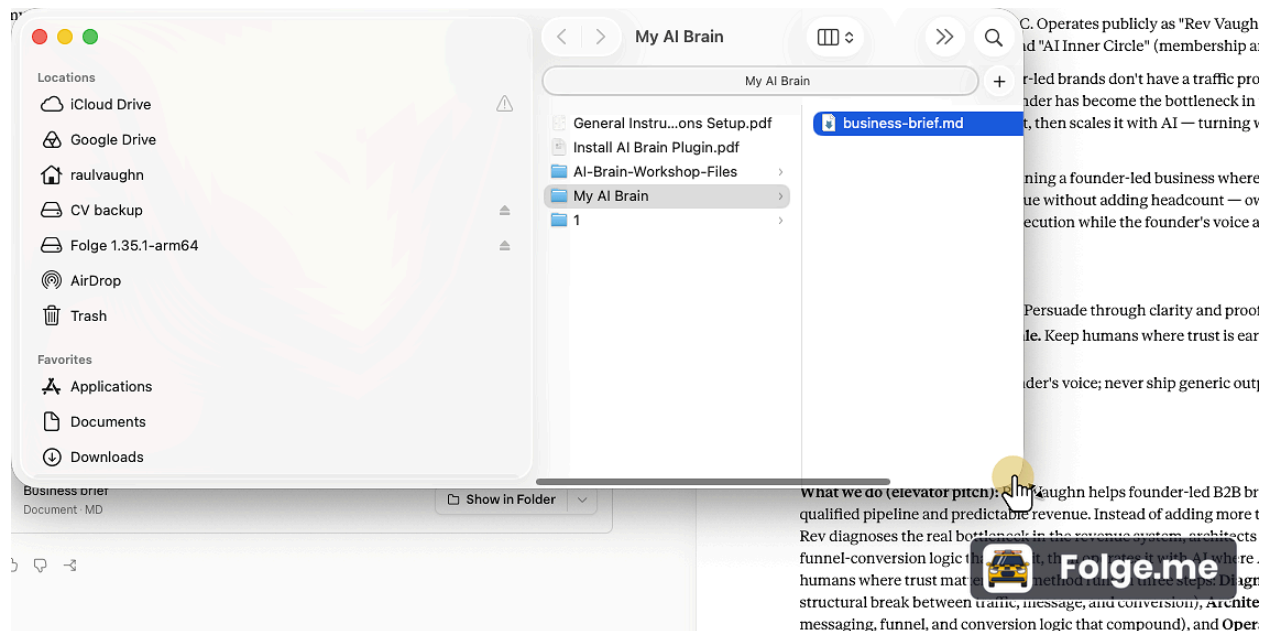
15 Review Your "Business Brief Core Identity



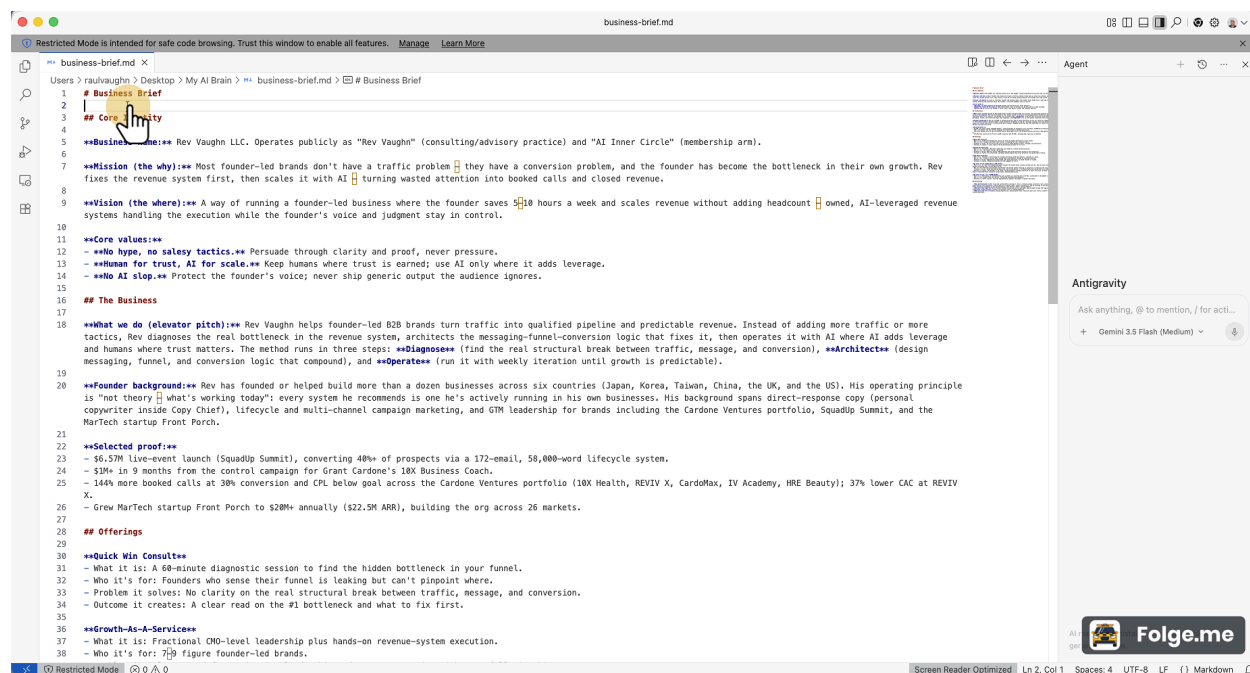
16 Click the "Show in folder" dropdown



17 Open "Business-brief.md" in a text editor program



18 Review and edit your Business Brief



Setup Guide 4 — Run the Rest & Build Your CLAUDE.md

~30-45 minutes. By the end: your AI Brain is live. All your knowledge files plus CLAUDE.md, loading automatically every time you open the folder. Each remaining skill works exactly like /business-brief. Do them in order. /blueprint-synthesis runs last.

Run /knowledge-domains

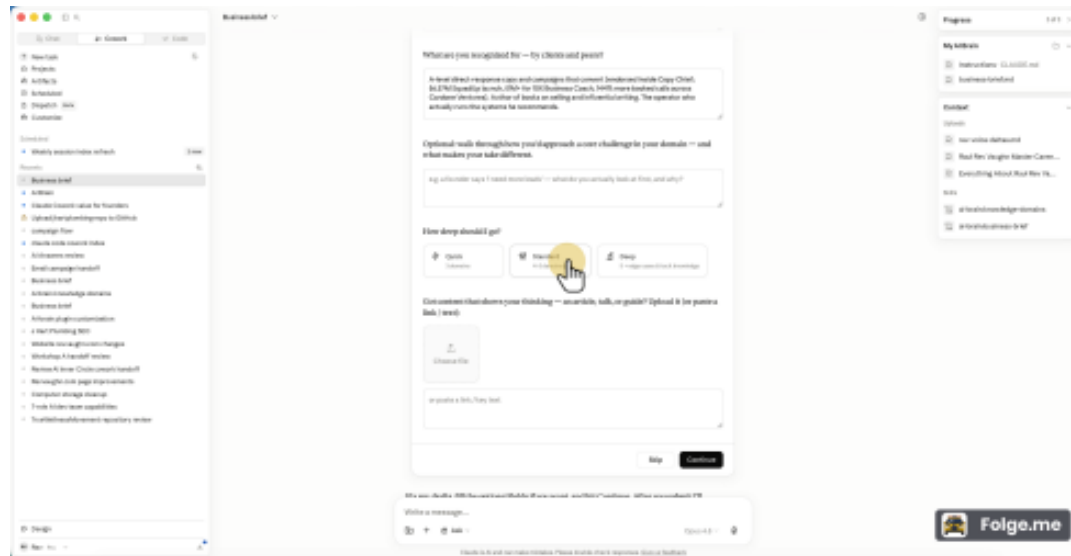
1. Type “/knowledge-domains” and click send (Enter does the same thing).
2. Answer the questions.
3. Add relevant URL(s) and files.
4. Click Send message.
5. Click Show in folder.
6. Open knowledge-domains.md in a text editor.
7. Review and make any edits.

Knowledge-domains

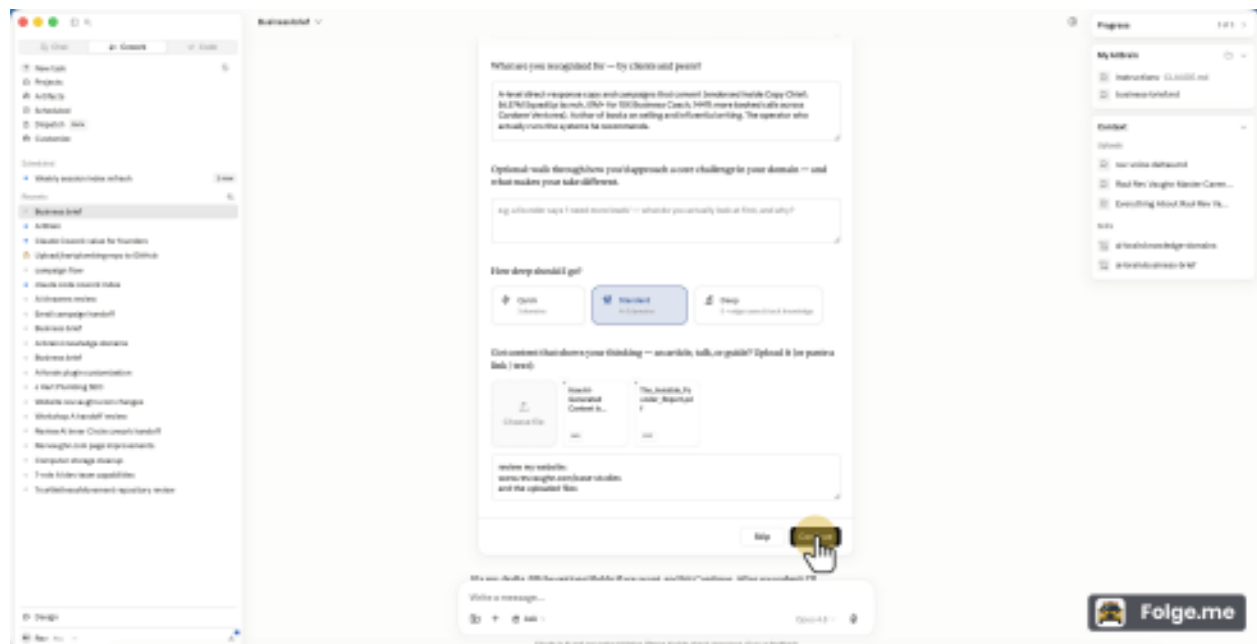
1 Type "/knowledge-domains" and click "send"



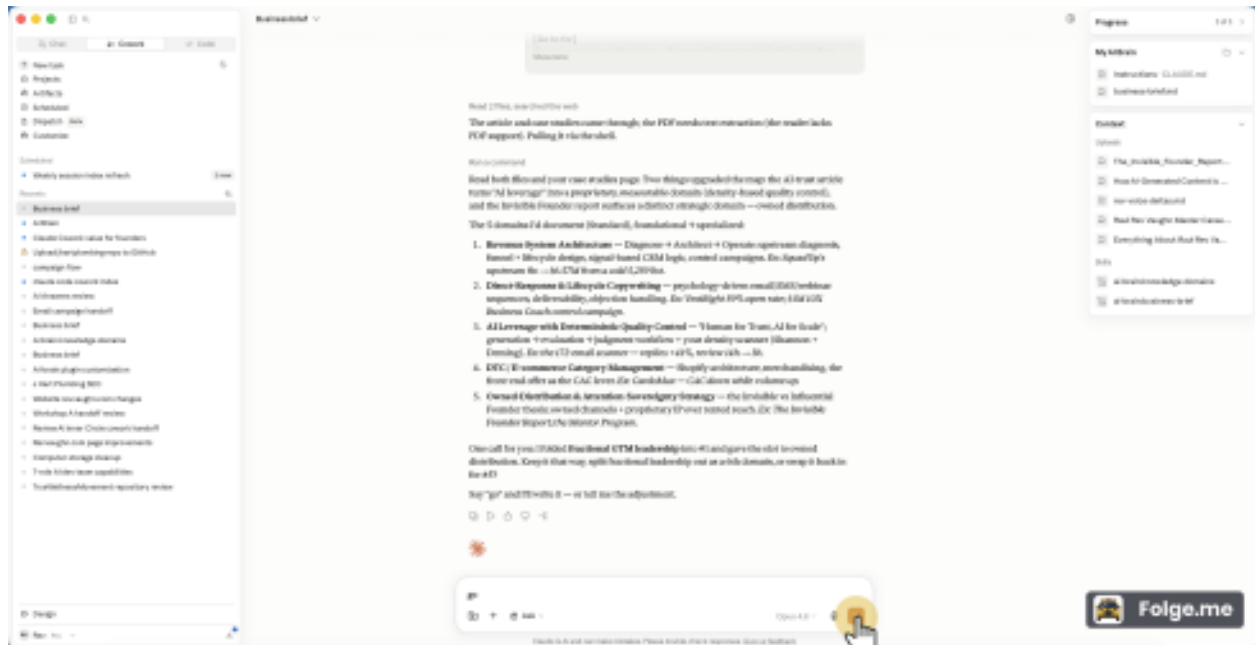
2 Answer questions



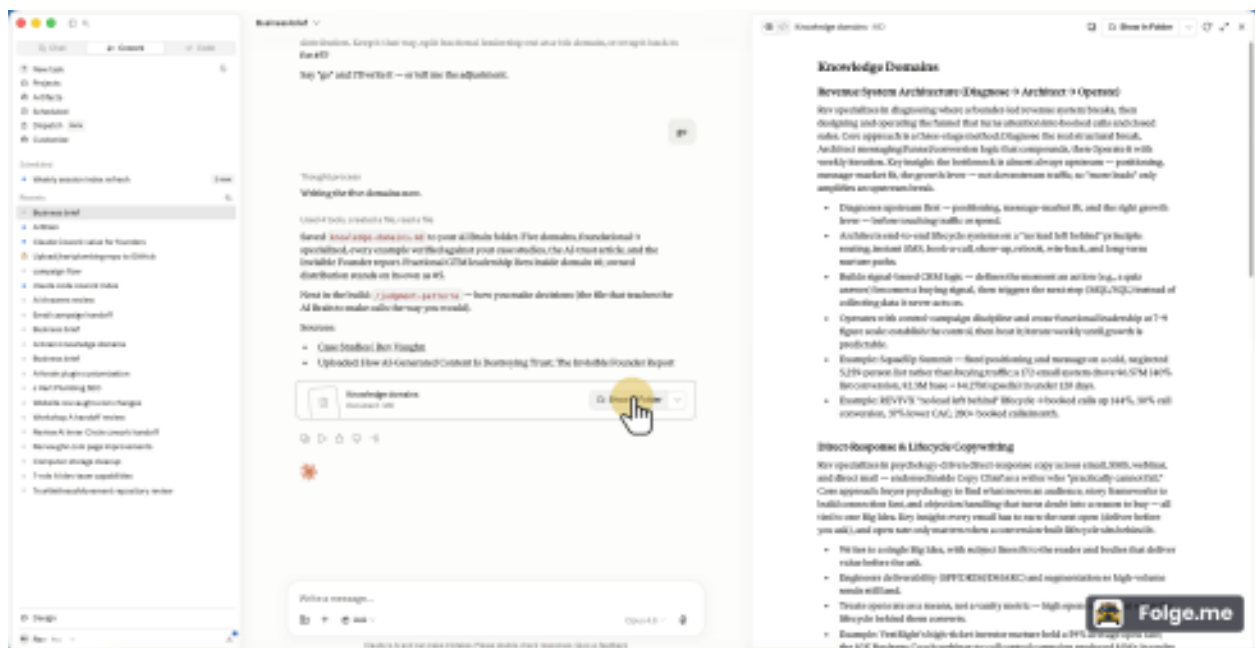
3 Add relevant URL(s) and files



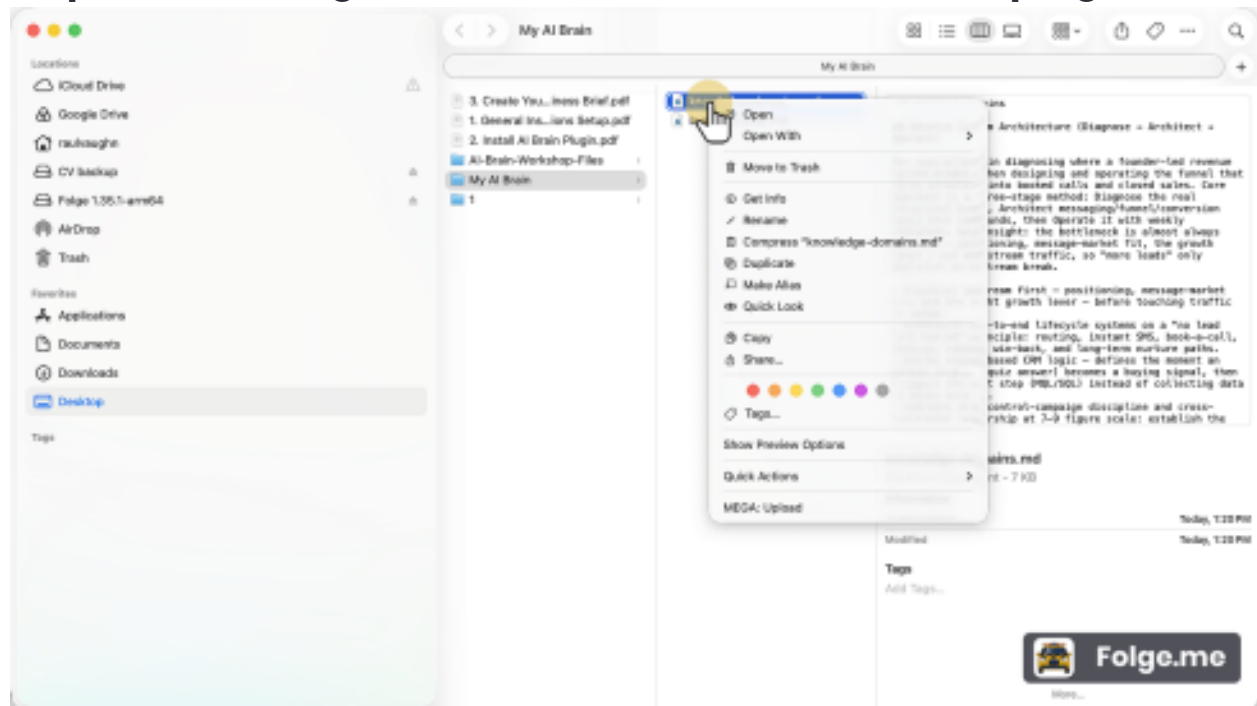
4 Click "Send message"



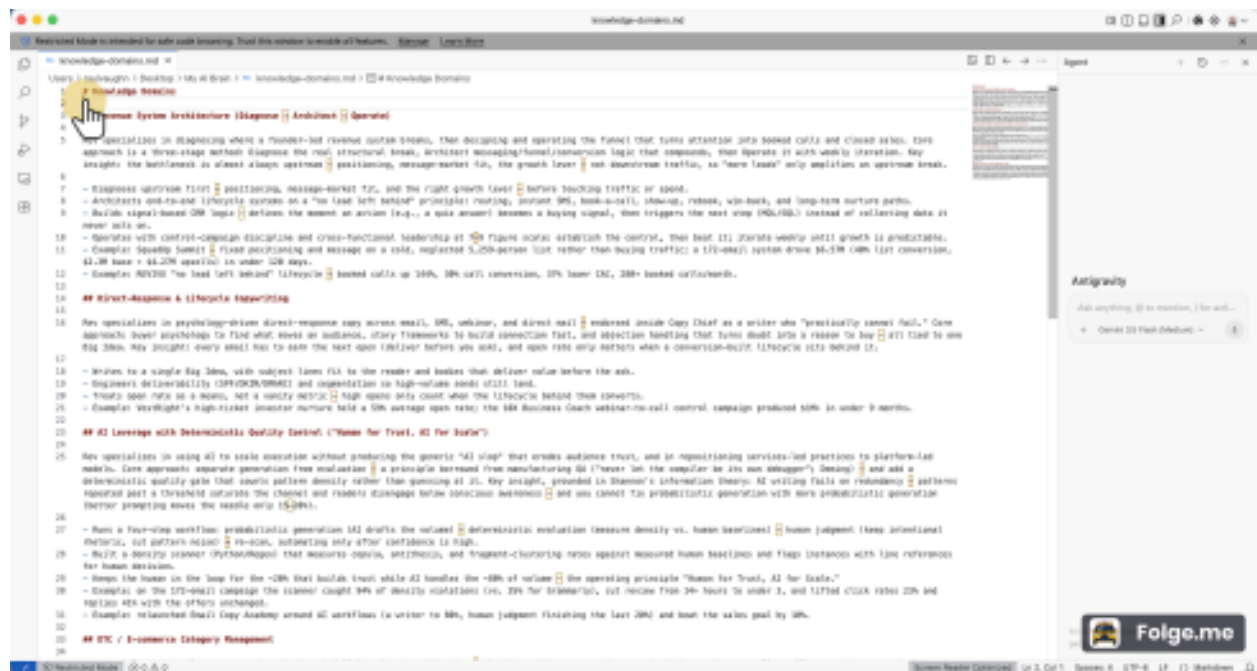
5 Click "Show in Folder"



6 open "knowledge-domains.md" with a text editor program



7 Review and make any edits

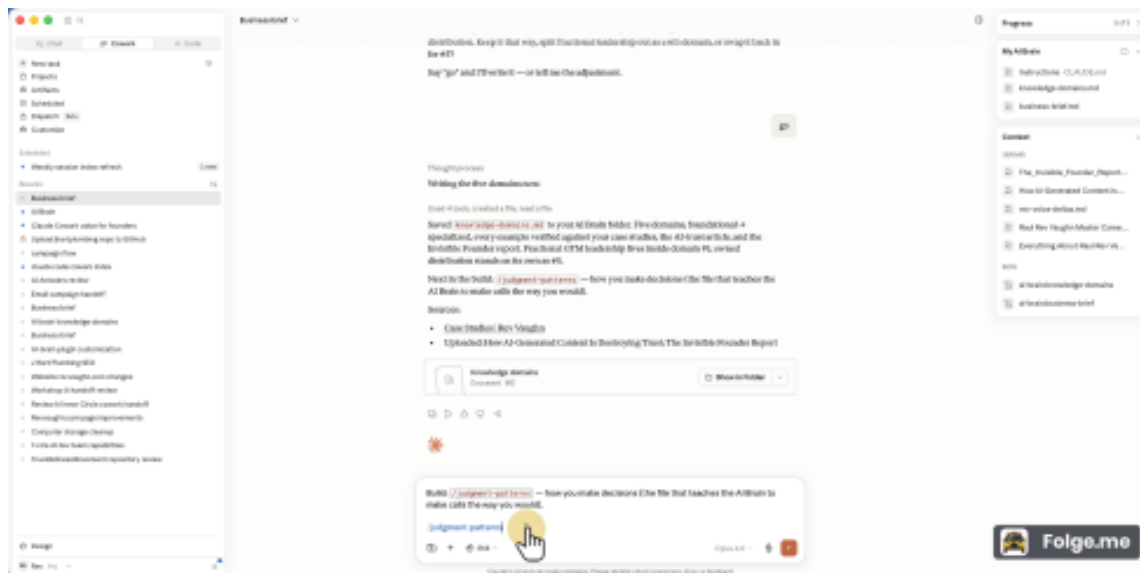


Judgment Patterns

1. Type `/judgment-patterns` and click send (Enter does the same thing).
2. Answer the questions.
3. Add relevant URL(s) or files.
4. Make any edits and say Go.
5. Review the output.
6. Click Show in folder.
7. Open judgment-patterns.md in a text editor.
8. Review and make any edits.

Judgment Patterns

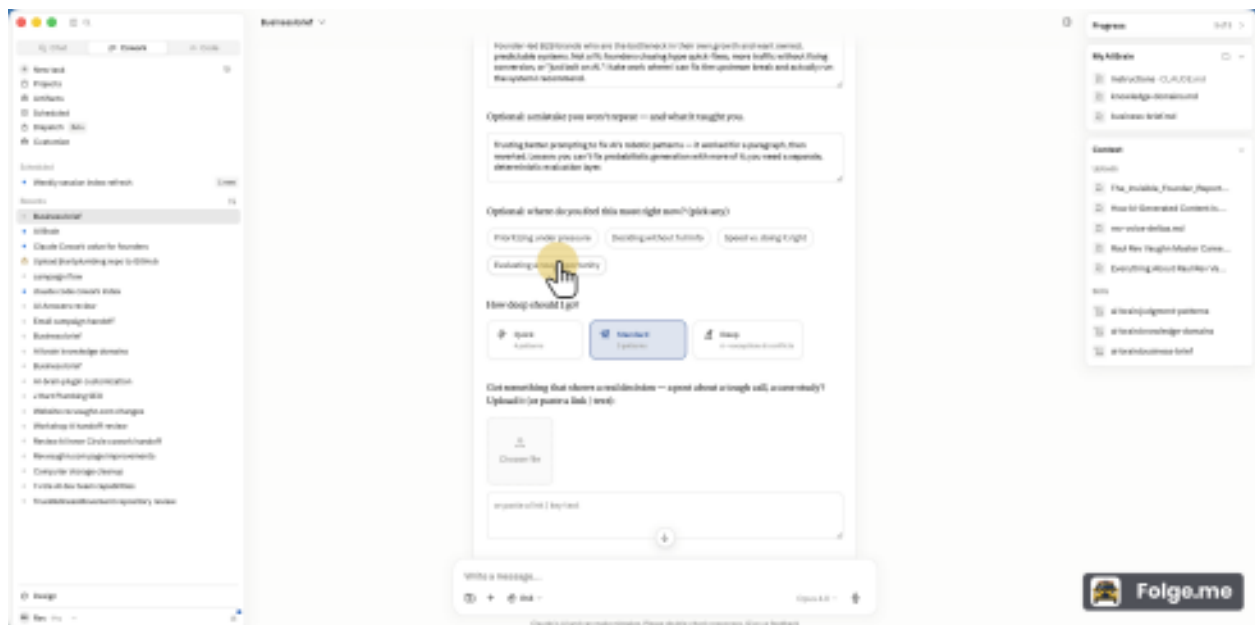
1 Type `/judgment-patterns` and click send



2 Answer Questions



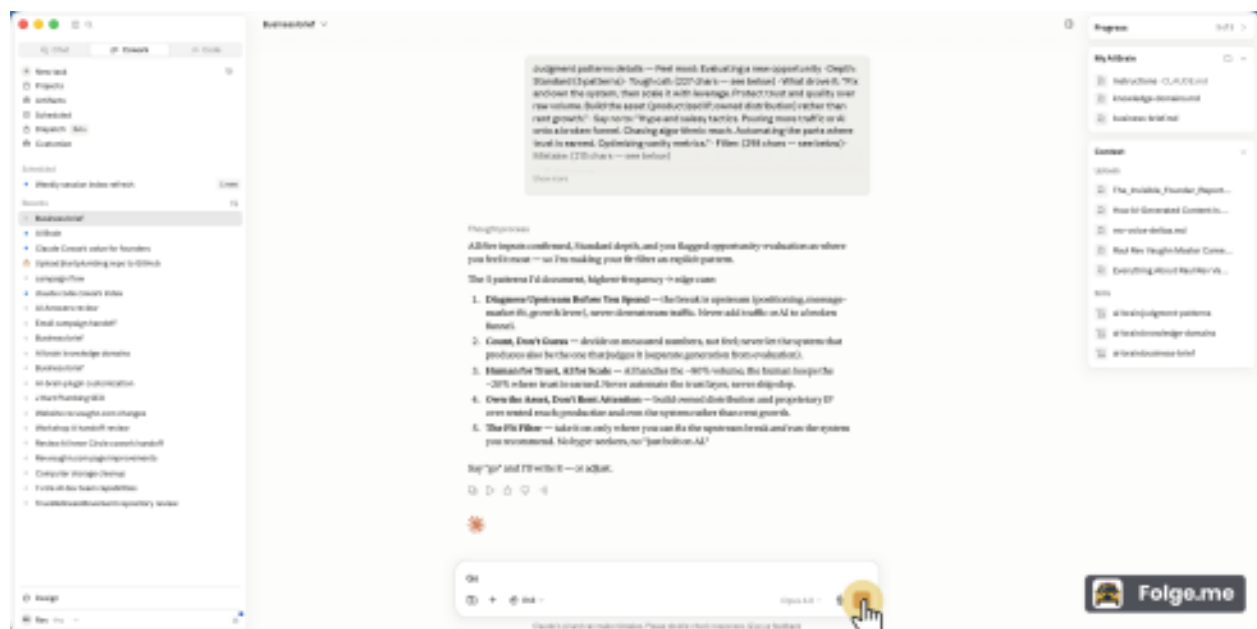
3 Add relevant URL(s) or files



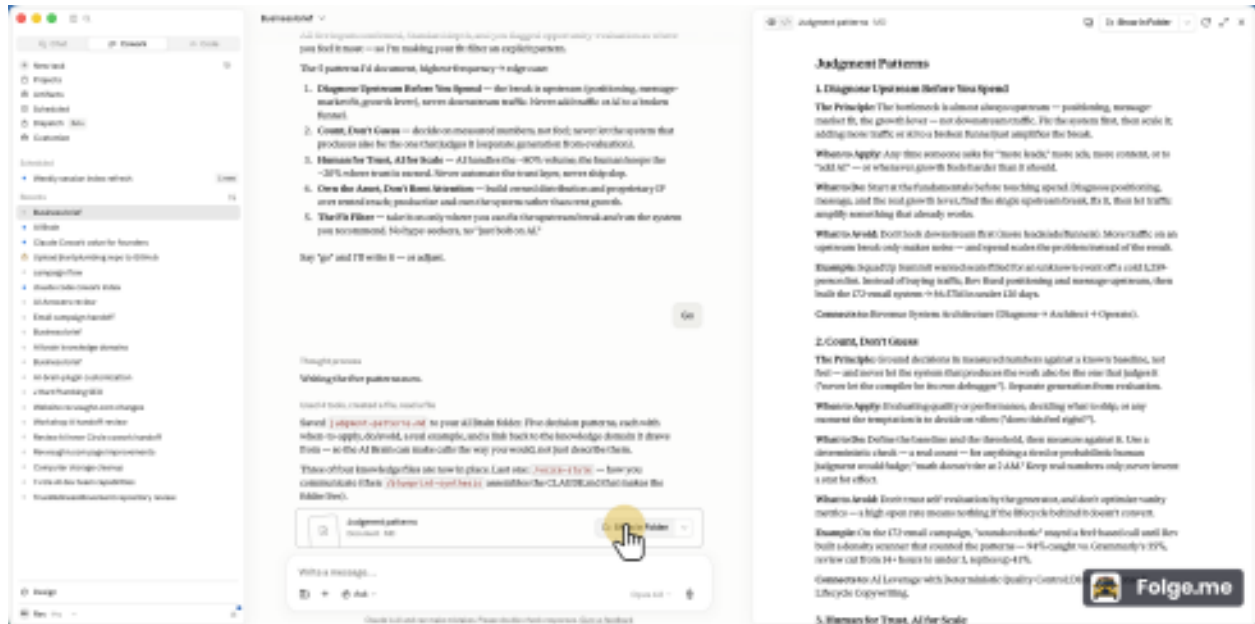
4 Make any edits and say "Go"



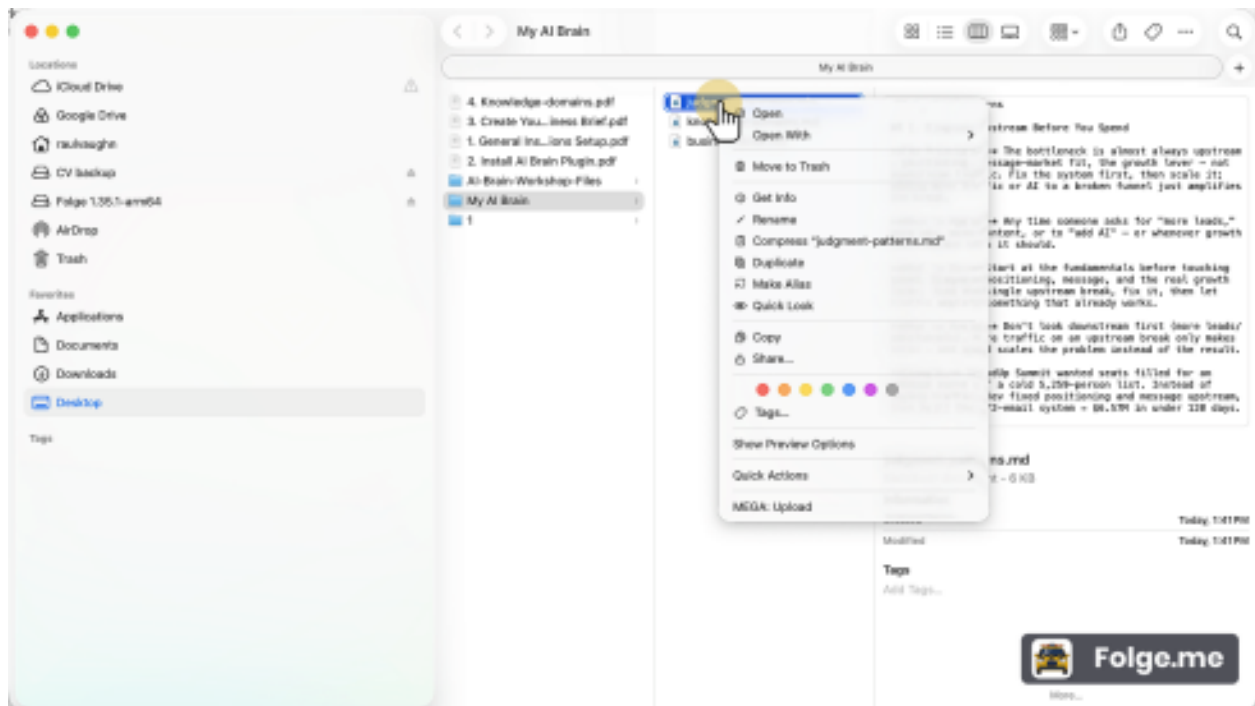
5 Review output



6 Click "Show in Folder"



7 Open "judgment-patterns.md" with a text editor program



8 Review and make any edits



Voice Style

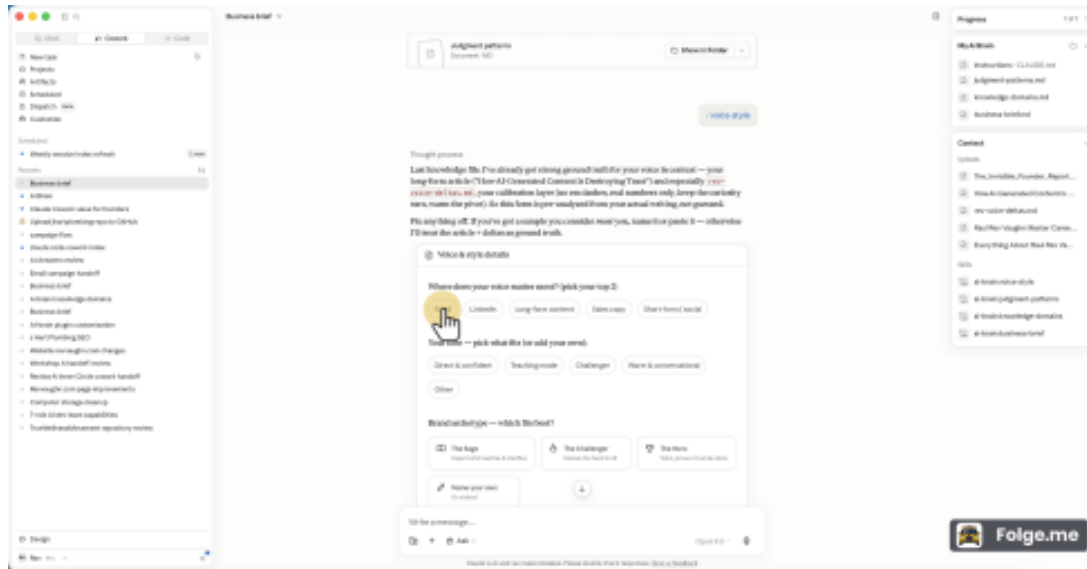
1. Type /voice-style and hit Send.
2. Answer the questions.
3. Choose the best answers.
4. Choose the best answers (next set).
5. Click Upload files.
6. Upload your writing samples (not AI-generated).
7. Click Continue.
8. Review and make edits.
9. Click Show in folder.
10. Open voice-style.md in a text editor.
11. Review and make edits.

Voice Style

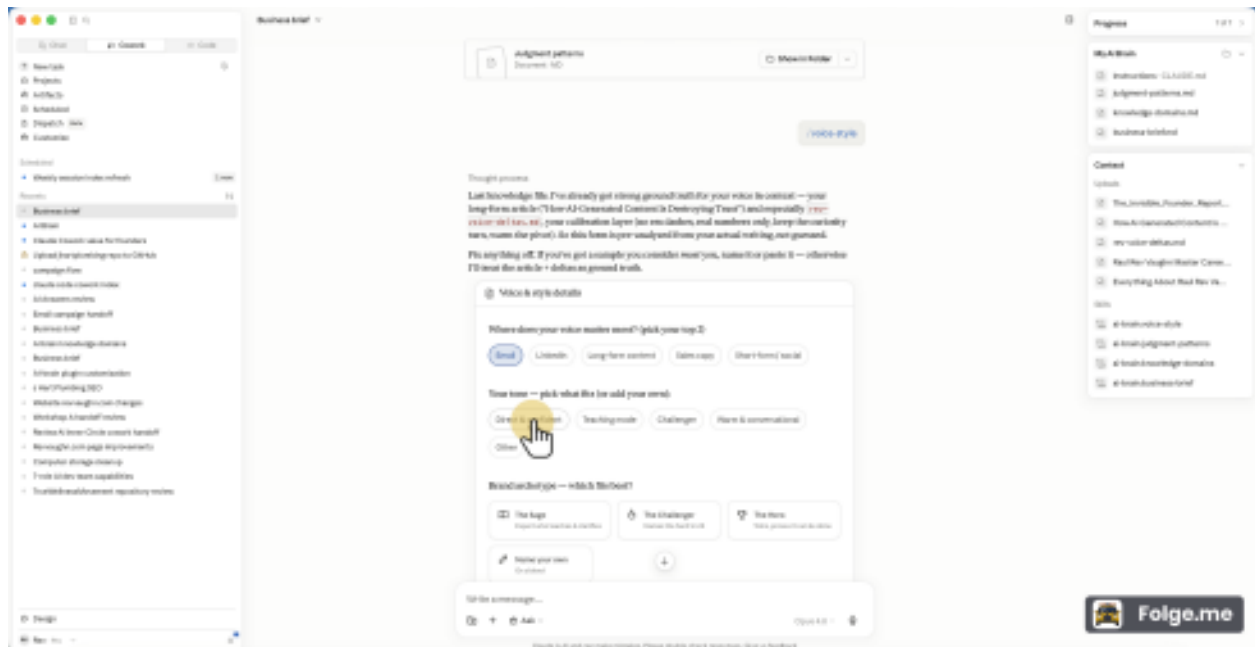
1 Type "/voice-style" and hit send



2 Answer questions



3 Choose the best answers



4 Choose the best answers

Business Model Canvas

Thought process

Last knowledge file I've already got strong grounds with the your value to content — your long-term article (You-All Generated Content is Entering Time) and integrity (You-All Generated Content) — your validation layer (you're studying and members only) long-term article (you're studying and members only) for this long-term study and from your actual writing, not ground.

For anything off, if you've got example you consider most you, sometimes paste it — otherwise I'll use the article + define as ground trials.

Where does your value matter most? (pick your top 2)

Small | Medium | Long-term content | Sales page | Share from social

How can you — pick what fits (or add your own)

Start to content | Learning mode | Challenge | Share to community

Brand archetype — which is best?

The Hero | The Rebel | The Explorer | The Creator | The Hero | The Rebel | The Explorer | The Creator

Finally, please provide your — things that would make progress in your value.

For details (and not), insert a recorded up-date. Repeatable words — "your change"

Get the message...

Follow me and learn more about me. Please share your feedback. (You're not a fool)

Progress

My A/B tests

- 1. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 2. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 3. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 4. Introduction - G.A. 1000

Content

- 1. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 2. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 3. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 4. Introduction - G.A. 1000

Follow me

5 Click "upload files"

Business Model Canvas

Thought process

Last knowledge file I've already got strong grounds with the your value to content — your long-term article (You-All Generated Content is Entering Time) and integrity (You-All Generated Content) — your validation layer (you're studying and members only) long-term article (you're studying and members only) for this long-term study and from your actual writing, not ground.

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Progress

My A/B tests

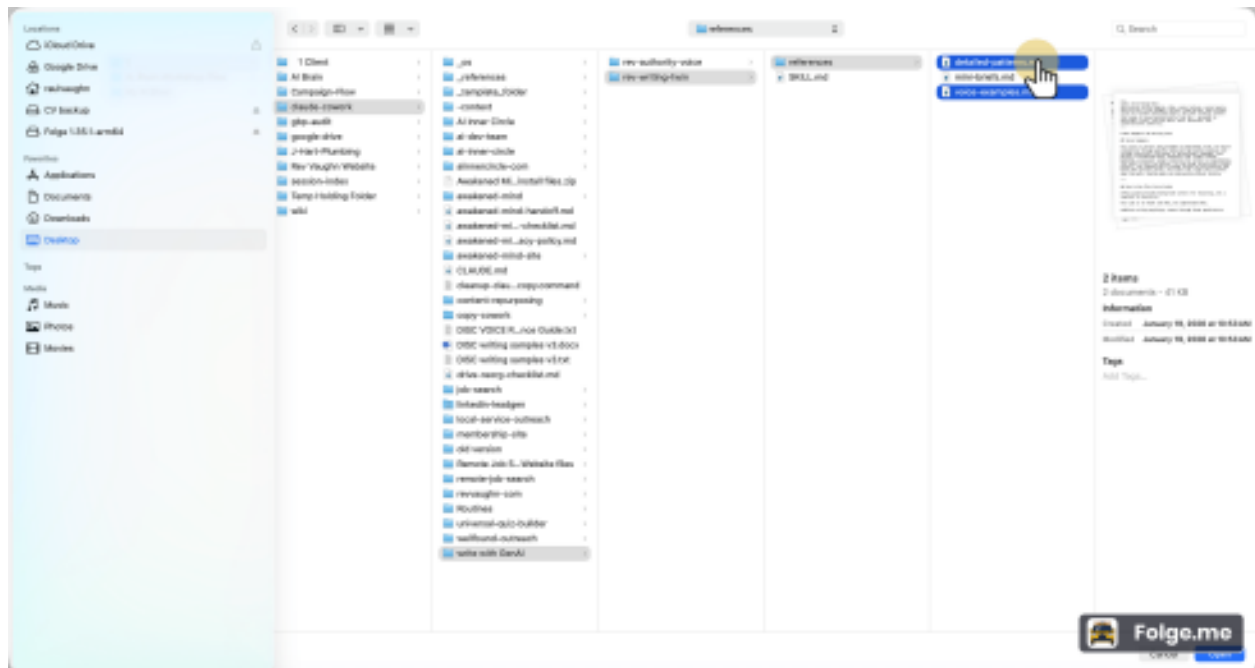
- 1. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 2. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 3. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 4. Introduction - G.A. 1000

Content

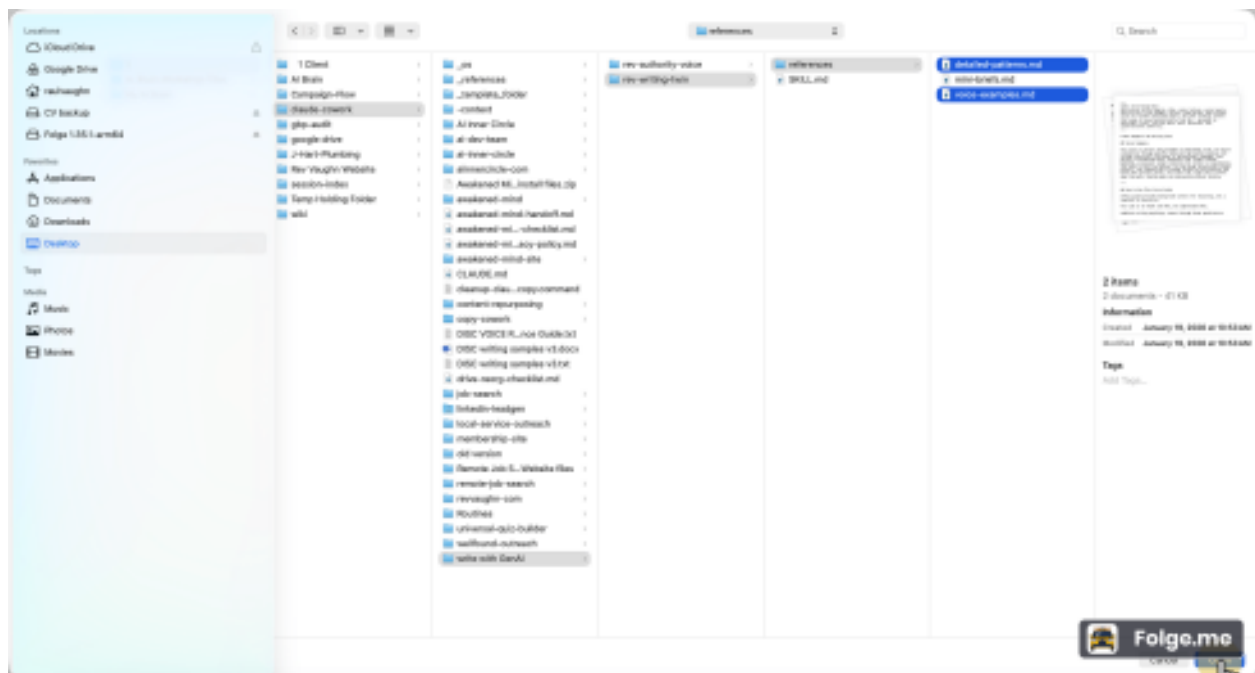
- 1. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 2. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 3. Introduction - G.A. 1000
- 4. Introduction - G.A. 1000

Follow me

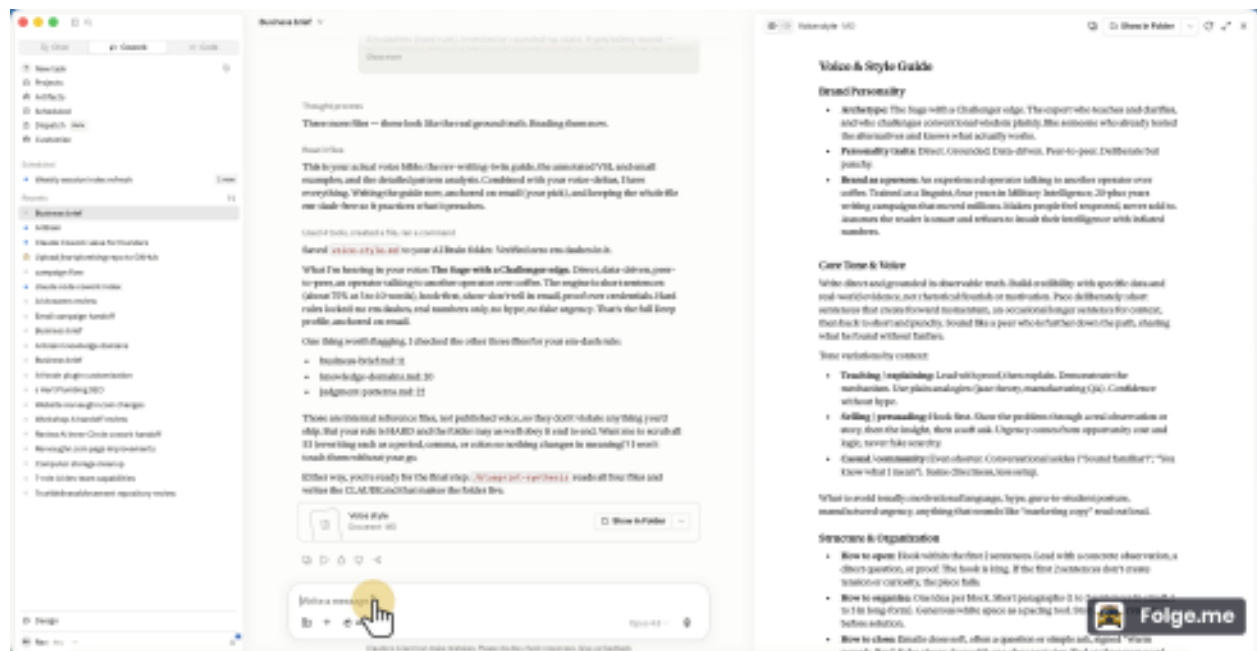
6 Upload your writing samples (not AI-generated)



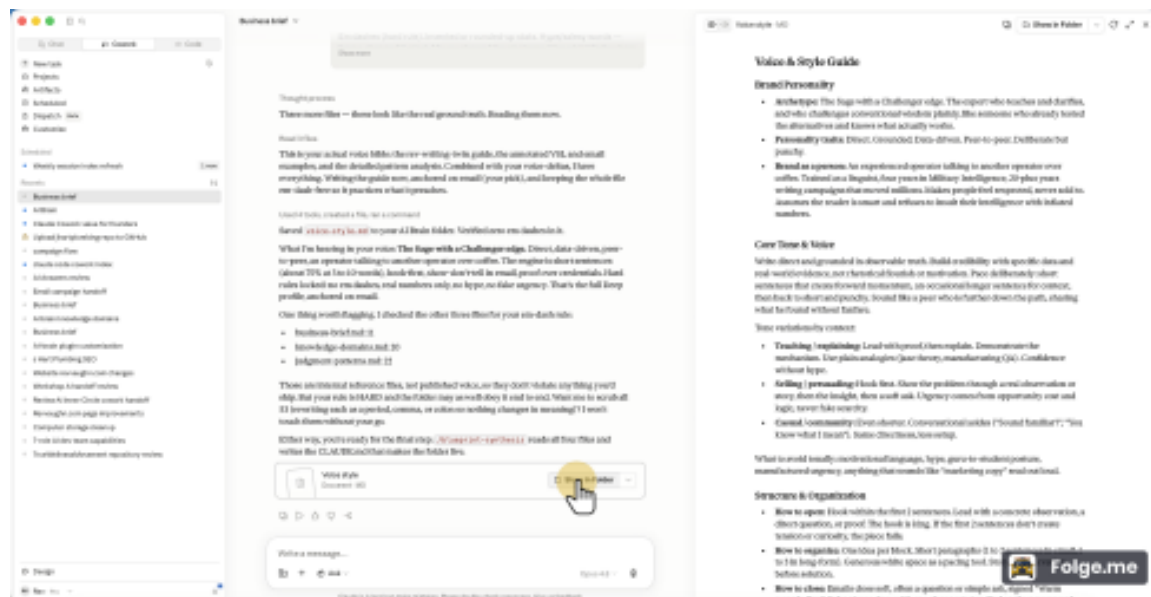
7 Click "continue"



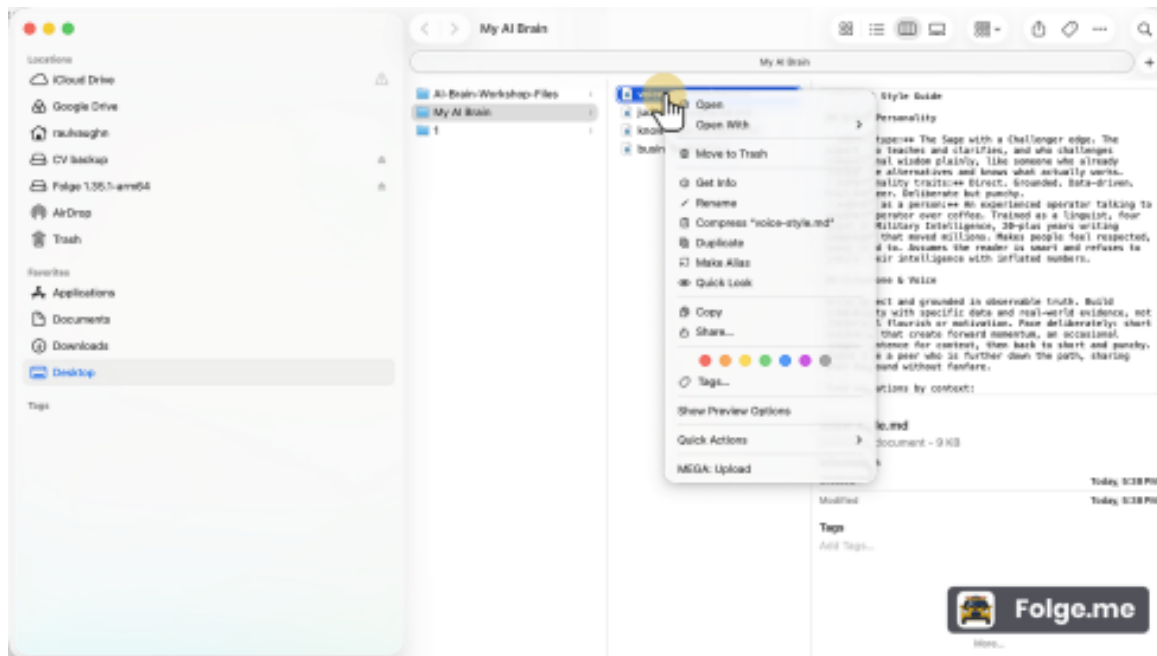
8 Review and make edits



9 Click "Show in Folder"



10 Open "voice-style.md" with a text editor



11 Review and make edits

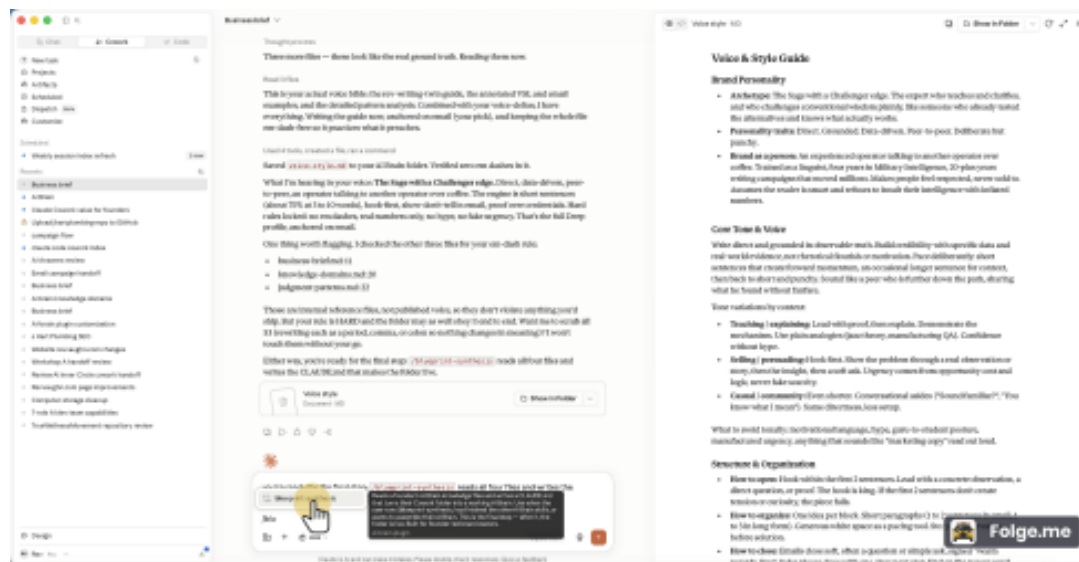


Blueprint Synthesis

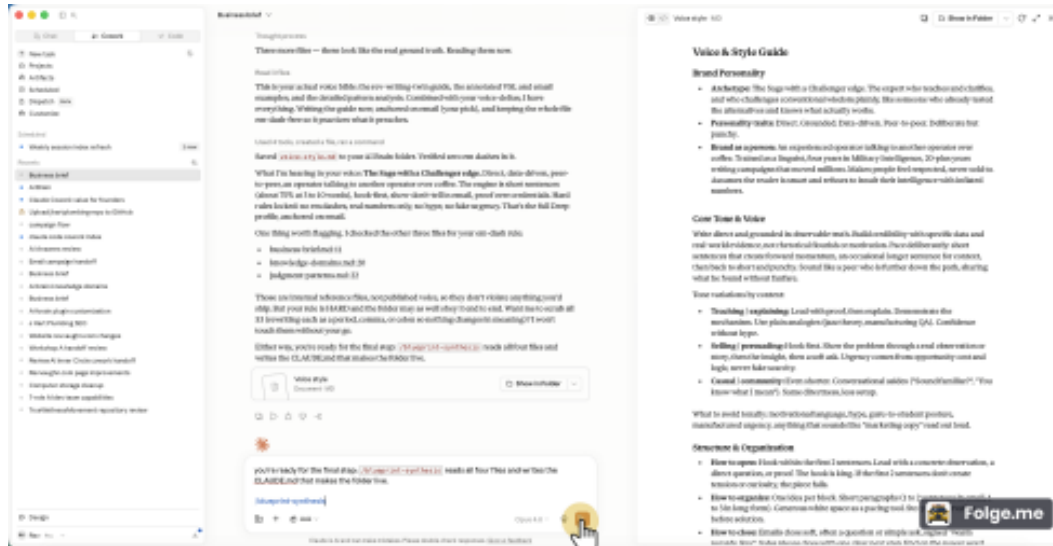
1. Type /blueprint-synthesis and click send (Enter does the same thing).
2. Click Send message.
3. Answer the questions.
4. Select the best answers and click Continue.
5. Make edits, then say Go.
6. Click Send message.
7. Review and make any edits.
8. Click Show in folder.
9. Open CLAUDE.md in a text editor.
10. Review and make any edits.

Create AI Brain CLAUDE.md file

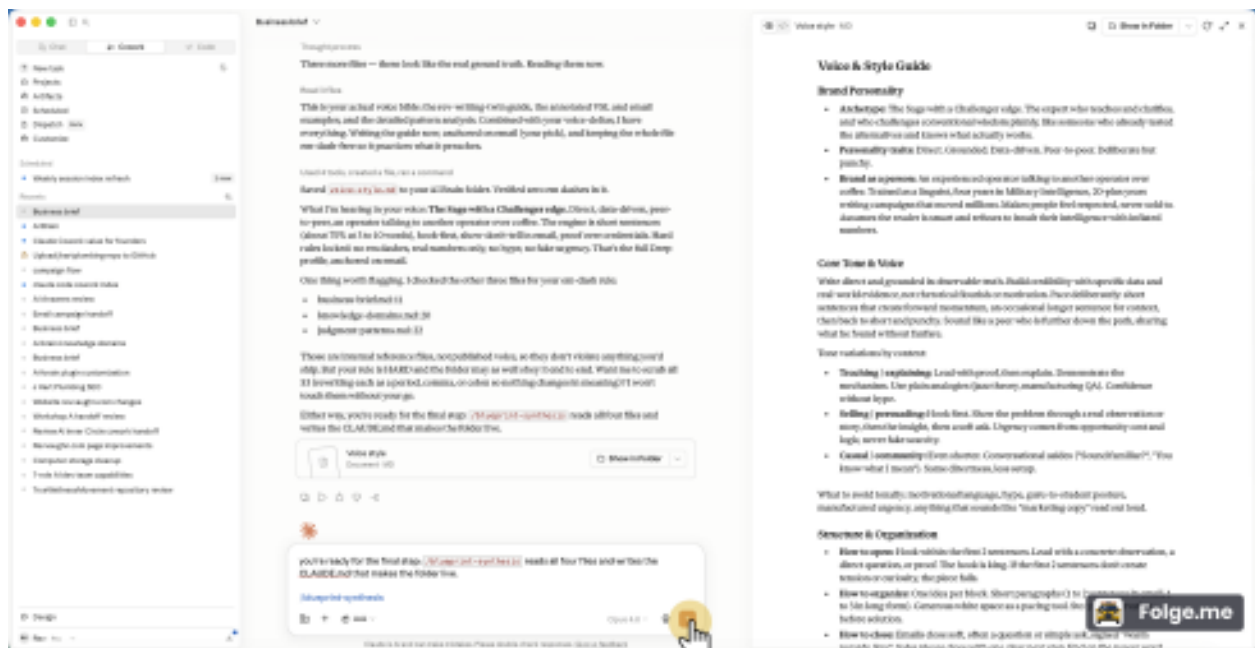
1 Type and click "/blueprint-synthesis" and click send



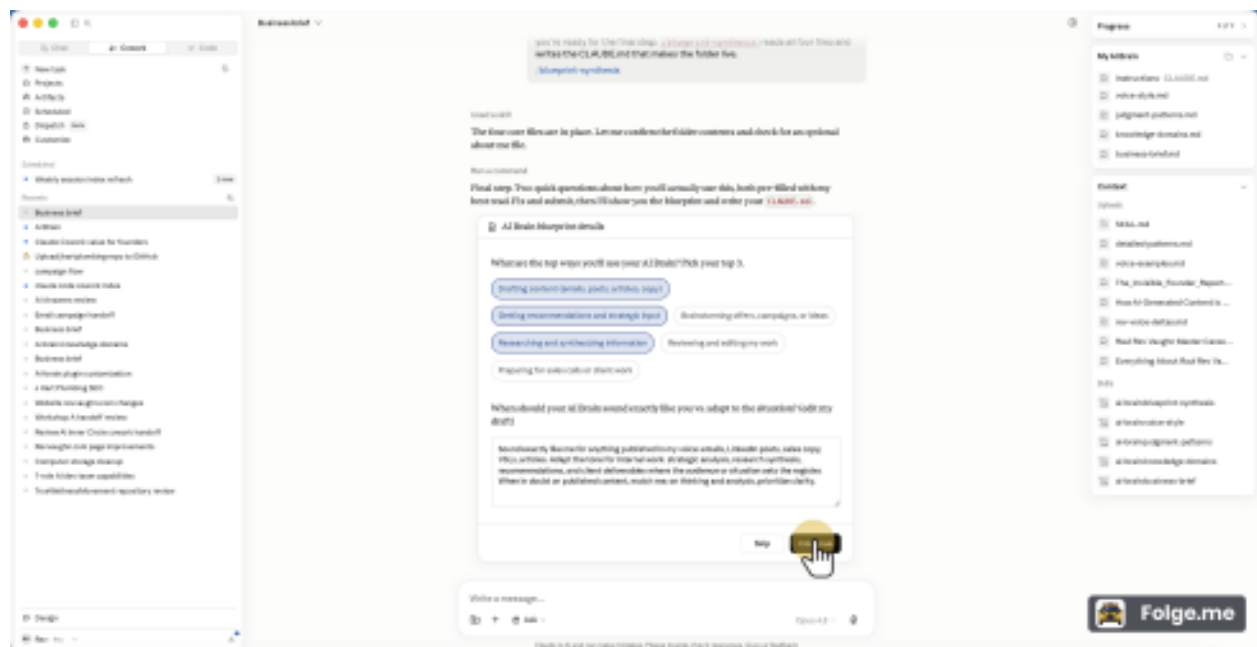
2 Click "Send message"



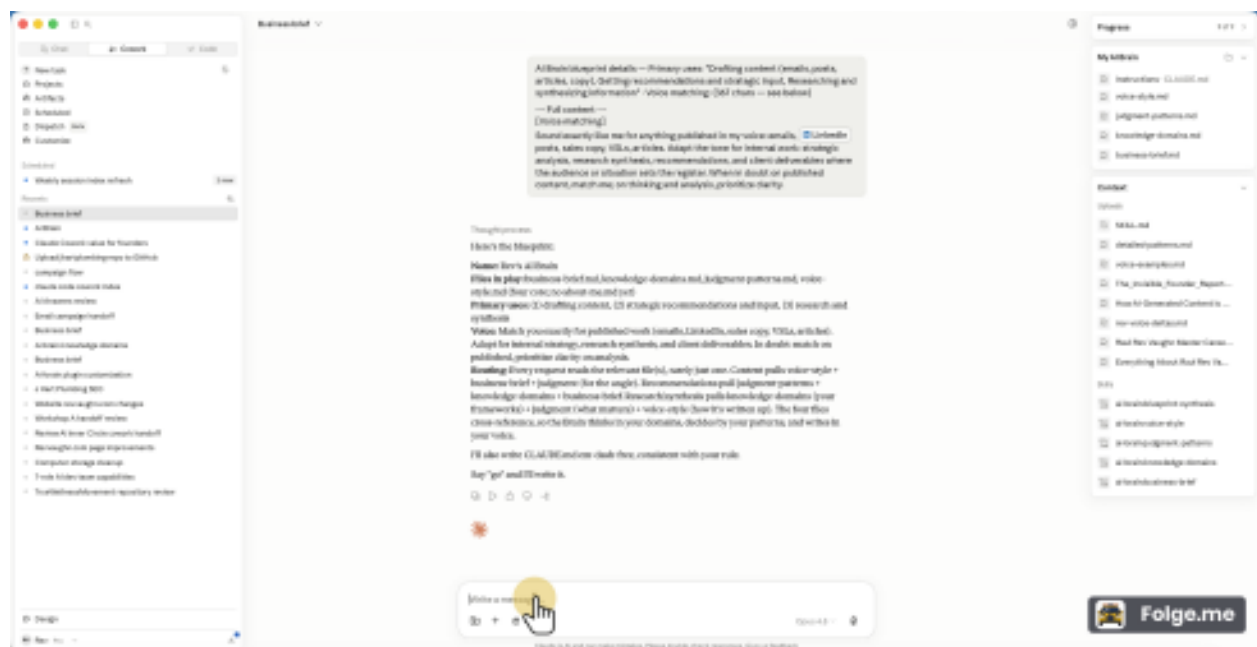
3 Answer Questions



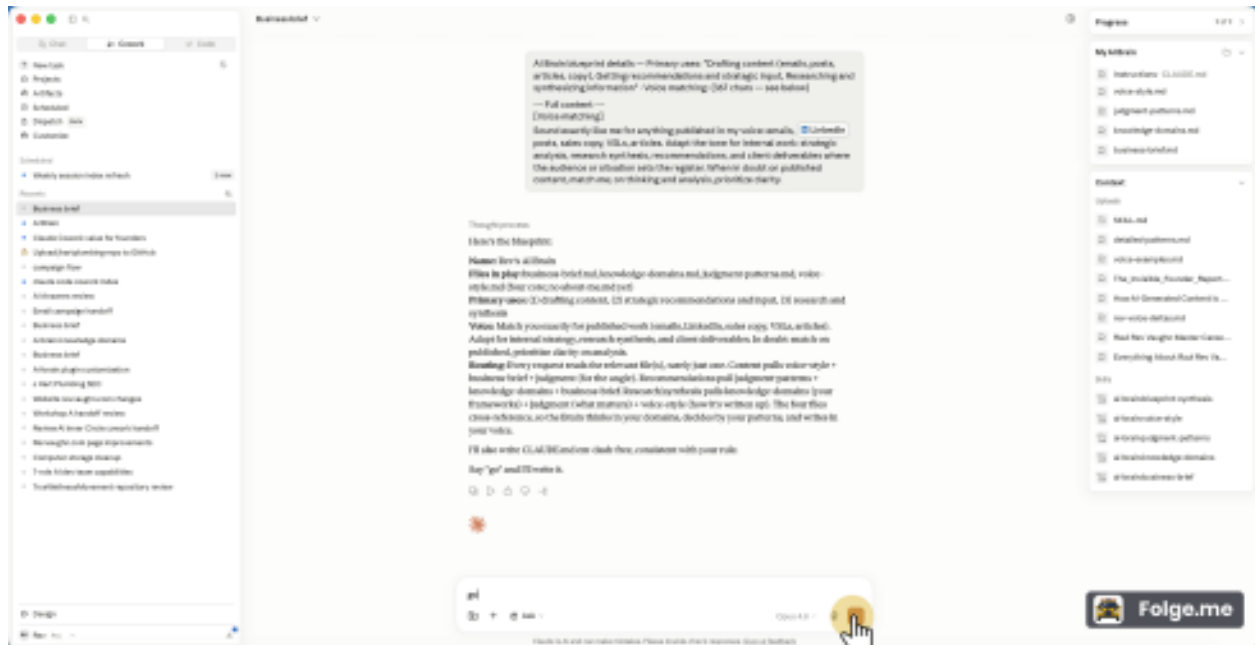
4 Select the best answers and click "continue"



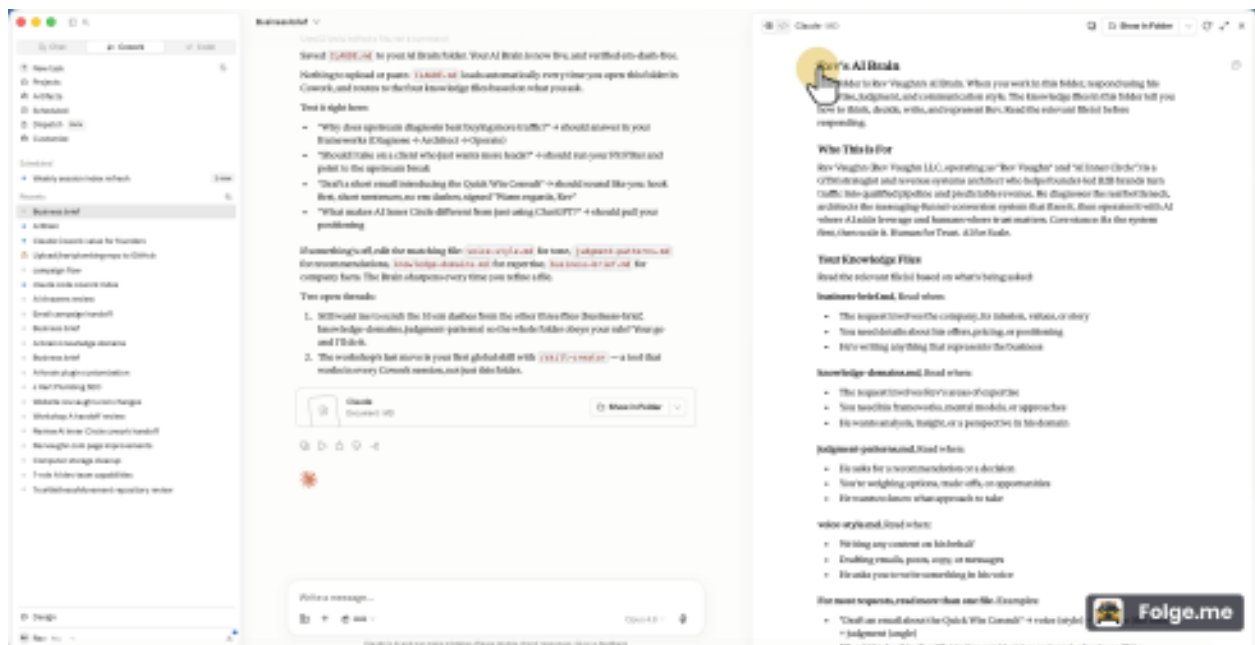
5 Make edits. Say "go"



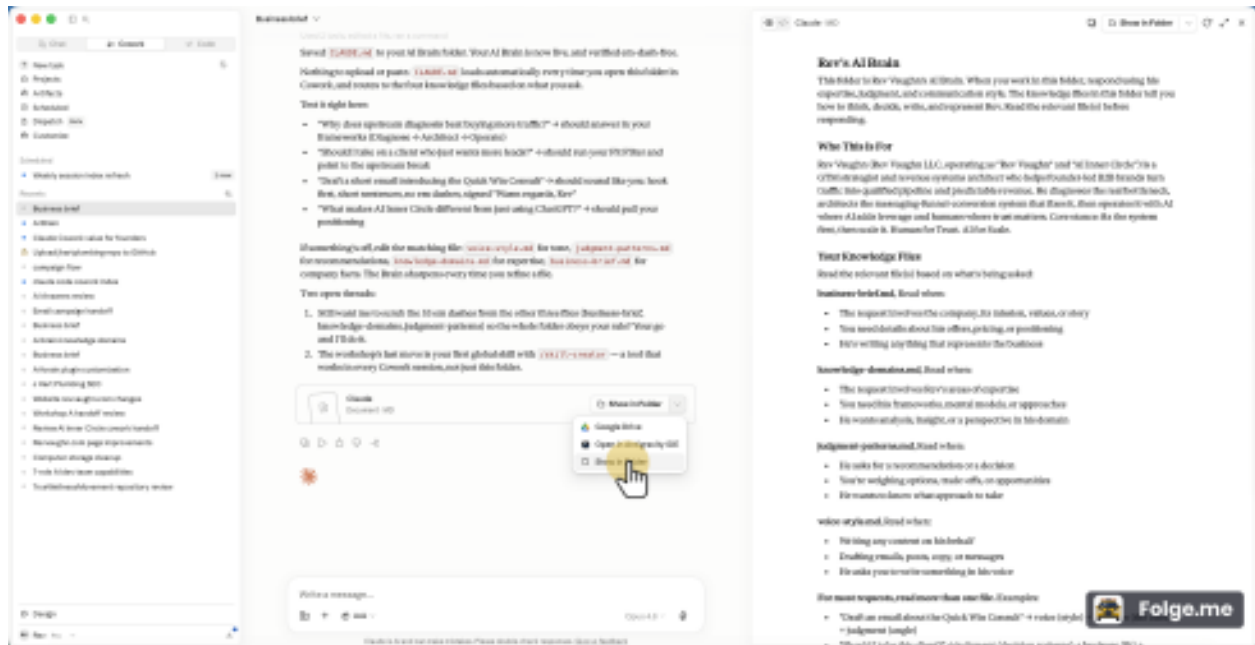
6 Click "Send message"



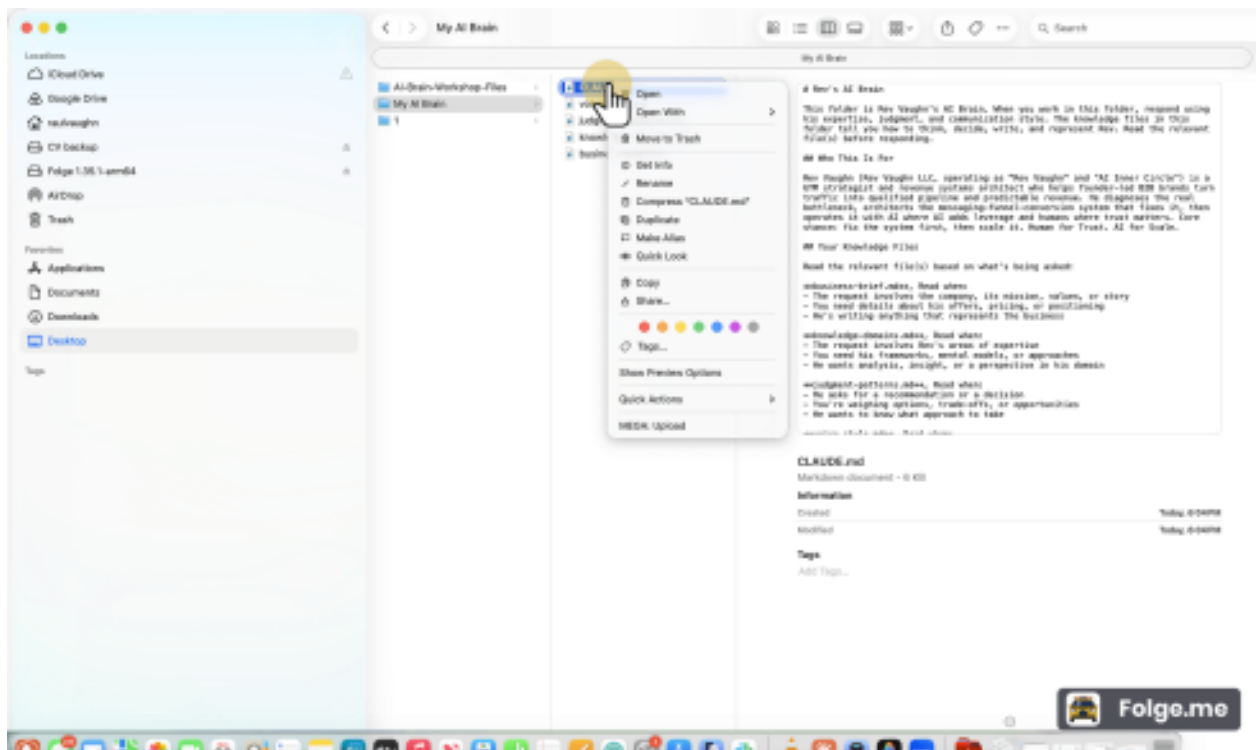
7 Review and make any edits.



8 Click "Show in Folder"



9 Open "CLAUDE.md" with a text editor program



10 Review and make any edits



Your AI Brain is live. Open the folder and you'll see your knowledge files plus CLAUDE.md. From now on, every time you open this folder in Cowork, Claude reads CLAUDE.md automatically with no pasting, no uploading.

Troubleshooting (any skill):

- **No / commands** → quit the app completely, reopen, return to Cowork, type / again.
- **"Which folder?"** → more than one folder connected; disconnect the extras, leave only My AI Brain.
- **Nothing wrote** → the task wasn't connected to My AI Brain. Reconnect it and re-run.

That's the hard part done. You built something most people using AI never will: a Claude that knows your business, your expertise, how you make decisions, and how you sound. Not a prompt you'll lose tomorrow.

You created a permanent, living, growing workspace that gets better each time you use it.

Section 5 — Your AI Brain Is Live (Test & Refine)

~10 minutes · the payoff

The moment /blueprint-synthesis wrote your CLAUDE.md, your AI Brain went live. Every time you connect this folder, Claude Cowork reads CLAUDE.md automatically.

Test It — Four Prompts

Run these inside your AI Brain folder. Each one targets a different knowledge file.

Test 1 — Expertise (knowledge-domains.md). Ask a question in your domain: *"What's your take on [specific challenge in my market]?"* It should answer using your frameworks, not generic advice.

Test 2 — Judgment (judgment-patterns.md). Ask for a recommendation: *"I have two options: [A] or [B]. What should I do?"* It should apply your actual decision patterns and not just list pros and cons.

Test 3 — Voice (voice-style.md). Ask it to write something short: *"Write a short email to my audience about the most important benefit of my offer."* Read it out loud. Does it sound like you?

Test 4 — Business facts (business-brief.md). Ask: *"What's our core offer, and who is it for?"* It should answer from your brief.

If Something Feels Off

Because everything lives in plain files in your folder, fixing your AI Brain is just editing a file. No re-uploading.

- **It doesn't sound like me** → open voice-style.md and add real examples from your writing, or re-run /voice-style.
- **Recommendations don't match how I'd decide** → open judgment-patterns.md; add concrete examples and "what to avoid" entries.
- **Wrong frameworks / missing expertise** → open knowledge-domains.md and add the missing mental models.
- **A business fact is wrong** → open business-brief.md and correct it.

Your AI Brain is not set-and-forget. It gets better every time you refine the files. Treat the first version as a working draft.

Section 6 — Build Your First Global Skill

~20 minutes · use it, make it yours, then build anything

Your AI Brain is live, but it only works inside that folder. For the things you do everywhere, you want a global skill. Built once, then available in every Cowork session, in every folder. The skills you ran today are global skills. That is why they appeared the moment you installed the plugin.

Today you will do three things, together. Use a skill we gave you. Reshape it to fit your business with `/skill-creator`. Then learn to build any skill you want with the same tool.

This section uses **Skill Creator**, a built-in Claude skill that builds and edits skills. Add it once. Already see `/skill-creator` when you type `“/skill-creator”`? Then it's on, skip this.

- In the left sidebar, click Customize, then Add skills, then Browse.
- Type `/skill-creator` to find it.
- Add the skill.
- Turn it on.
- Back in your task, type `/` and confirm `/skill-creator` shows up.

Part 1: Use the “site-content-creator” Skill

You already have a skill called “site-content-creator”. It came with the workshop materials. It writes website content for your business: landing pages, blog posts, and opt-in pages. It reads your AI Brain, so it already knows your voice, your offers, and your proof.

Try it now.

1. Open a Cowork session in your “My AI Brain” folder. (New task, then Work in a project or folder, then Desktop, then My AI Brain, then Open.)
2. Type `“/site-content-creator”` and click send (Enter does the same thing).
3. Give it a real job: *“Write a landing page for [your main offer].”*
4. Answer the few questions it asks. Who the page is for, the one offer and the single call to action, and the proof you want to feature.
5. Read what it gives you. It also saved a copy to your outputs folder.

That is a skill doing in two minutes what used to take an hour, in your voice, from your own facts. Now you will make it yours.

Part 2: Make It Yours with `/skill-creator`

The skill you just ran is a starting point. `/skill-creator` lets you reshape it to fit your business exactly. The page types you actually sell. Your channels. Your rules. Even the name.

This is the move that matters. You are not stuck with a skill someone else built. You bend it to your work.

1. In your My AI Brain folder, type:
/skill-creator

(Enter does the same thing).

2. Tell it what to change, in plain words. For example:

"Using "skill-creator", build a customized version of my "site-content-creator" skill for my business and offer. Save it under a new name, like [yourbrand]-content, so it sits next to the original. Ask me questions first."

3. Answer its questions.
4. Let it revise the skill, then test the updated skill on a real page.
5. Click Save skill. Your customized version is installed and ready in any session.

What to Tell It (this is the part that matters)

These are the questions /skill-creator asks for any skill. Your answers are what separate a skill that feels like you from one that feels generic. Be specific.

- **What should this skill do?** Name the job in one line. "Write ready-to-publish website content in my voice."
- **When should it trigger?** The phrases you would actually type. "A landing page, a blog post, an opt-in page, or site copy."
- **What information does it need?** Your AI Brain for voice and facts. Then, per job, the content type, the audience, the one offer and call to action, and the real proof.
- **What does a good output look like?** A hook in the first two sentences. Short sentences. One offer, one call to action. Real numbers only. Saved to the outputs folder. It should sound like you read out loud, not like marketing copy.
- **What rules should it always follow?** Your editorial rules, the same ones in your voice-style file. One offer per page. Real numbers only, never invented. Read my AI Brain first.

Answer like this, and the skill comes out sharp. Rush the answers, and they come out generic. The quality of the skill is the quality of your answers.

Part 3: Now Build Any Skill You Need

You just used /skill-creator to reshape a skill. The exact same process builds a new skill from nothing.

Type /skill-creator. Describe what you want in one line:

"I want to build a skill that [does X] for [my work]." Add "Ask me questions first."

Then answer the questions it asks. When it gives you the Save skill button, click it. The skill is installed. Test it by typing /[your-skill-name] in any session.

That is the whole pattern. Anything you do over and over, where Claude would do it better if it already knew your approach, can become a skill. Good ones to build next:

- **Write in my voice.** Drafts emails, posts, or messages using your voice guide.
- **Brainstorm offers.** Generates offer ideas using your market knowledge and positioning.
- **Review my copy.** Grades any piece of copy against your standards.
- **Client prep.** Gathers what you need before a sales call or client meeting.

The best next skill is the one you would use tomorrow.

What's Next

You have built Layer 1 (Global Instructions), Layer 2 (your AI Brain), and you can now use, customize, and build global skills.

The next workshop in this series is where your AI Brain becomes a co-worker that takes action and does work by connecting your calendar, email, and docs, running scheduled tasks, and growing your skill library (and a whole lot more). Between now and then, use your AI Brain and your skills on real work.

The more you use it, the better it gets.